

From: [ALAN DUGUID](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Written Submission of Comment on Bylaw 2026-007, Redesignation from RG to RI
Date: June 1, 2026 1:33:05 PM
Attachments: [June 03rd Land Rezoning Submission - A. Duguid.docx](#)

Good afternoon,

Please find attached a Written Submission of Comment on the subject Bylaw. I believe this submission follows all of the published guidelines however if you could let me know I would appreciate it. If it is rejected or redacted I still have time to edit and resubmit. Please note that I am submitting these comments as an individual.

thank you

regards

Alan Duguid

Little Bow [REDACTED]

Submission of Comment to Vulcan County Bylaw
Amendment 2026 – 007
Redesignation from Rural General to Rural Industrial

This paper will discuss the rezoning application Bylaw Amendment 2026-007 which proposes to rezone the subject land parcel from RG to RI. It intrinsically recognises that there can be no denying that the subject application is directly and irrevocably linked to a proposed concept by the Applicant to build an industrial development on the rezoned lands, of unprecedented size and impact, in the future. A document exceeding 40 pages, describing the concept, is appended to this application.

I will be affected in many ways by the proposed rezoning and the industrial development which will likely result, as follows:

1. The impacts of new industrial development on the subject lands will add to the presently largely undefined impacts from existing industrial development along highway 529, in a cumulative manner. These impacts include, but are not limited to,
 - water quality and pollution in the Travers Reservoir
 - significant additional pollution including industrial emissions, light, noise, smoke, odour and heat
 - increased heavy truck traffic and dust
 - negative impacts to the large populations of both resident and migratory birds
2. An increased risk of fire, especially grass fires, which are a particular danger in the dry and often high wind environment in the local area. This increased risk could significantly affect my property and those of my neighbours.

These issues are discussed in more detail below.

It is instantly clear from a reading of this appendix, that it does not describe a project. It simply envisions a concept, given that there is virtually no engineering or environmental study supporting it. No equipment could be ordered and nothing could be built from the information provided. Essentially, what is being considered here is a preliminary guess as to the potential stresses on local resources and impacts that this proposed concept will have on its surroundings. Indeed, it is entirely possible that an industrial development concept completely different and at present unknown might ultimately be brought forward for the subject lands. It is upon that guess that Council is being asked to judge whether the rezoning application is appropriate, responsible, safe and worthy of approval.

Vulcan County land Use Bylaw 2020-028 states as follows: PURPOSE - To allow industrial uses to be located in rural areas provided they do not pose a threat to the environment or create a potential nuisance for residents. These are fine words.

The Government of Canada (Environment and Natural Resources) defines cumulative effects as follows: the changes in the environment caused by multiple interactions among human activities and natural processes, which accumulate across time and space.

The Government of Alberta also has a very useful definition of cumulative effects and their management, issued by the Land Use Secretariat, that discusses “setting and integrating the economic, environmental and social outcomes that Albertans want to achieve” and “defining threshold values for identifying adverse impacts on the land base”.

Perhaps, to start, an investigation of the cumulative effects of all presently existing industrial installations along highway 529 should be completed, before the addition of further contiguous development is

considered. Presently this includes Travers Solar, the proposed BESS project (that is now in abeyance until Axium Infrastructure can figure out their own ownership structure) and Buffalo Plains Wind. I am aware of no work to consider these cumulative impacts having been studied by the owners of any of these projects. The application for the proposed Battery Electric Storage System (or BESS) project on the Solar Farm simply states: “the addition of the BESS is not expected to result in significant cumulative impacts and/or socioeconomic effects” with no evidence found in that application which offers support for this statement, and certainly not within the bounds of the definitions referenced above.

There is no consideration in this present rezoning application for any cumulative effects (both environmental and social) of the proposed rezoning and the heavy industry that will result, on the surroundings.

How will new industry on the subject lands add to those already undefined impacts? It is impossible to tell, as no work has been done. Why is the approval of new land for industrial zoning even being considered by Council, when there has been no evident evaluation made on a concept to concentrate future developments onto lands which are already in industrial use? Densification is the term used here. Would it not be prudent to instruct present and future land rezoning proponents to at least consider brownfield developments rather than continuing to sacrifice agricultural land (and environmental stewardship) to the constantly growing demands of industry?

Council should also be concerned about the increased fire danger to our County from a new industrial development and how the County fire service, which serves us so well, might be given the tools and training to fight LI-ion battery fires both at the proposed BESS and potentially the industry built on the rezoned lands in question? Reading the report from the fire that occurred at Travers Solar this past March it is evident

that new firefighting issues are already emerging as a result of the present industrial installations. What issues will emerge from further industrial development and how will these issues, when combined with the requirements from the existing industrial sites, be addressed? This is a matter of criticality of life.

Given that there is no detail whatsoever on the industrial development proposed for the rezoned land in question and no understanding of these cumulative impacts and potentially increased fire dangers which must exist, how can risks to the environment and local residents be evaluated and therefore how can this proposed bylaw amendment even be considered? There is not enough information to judge whether a threat to the environment exists, (which Bylaw 2020-028 demands).

Council is requested to consider the existing bylaws and the undefined request before it and admit that the potential impacts and dangers of a potential gargantuan industrial installation which could very likely ruin the entire Travers area and potentially very much more, are completely unknown. And yet Council is again, being asked to grant the requested amendment in the absence of all pertinent information on these impacts and risks, potentially stemming from its' decision. As the elected Stewards of Vulcan County, responsible through our own bylaw to protect the environment and county residents and taxpayers, please exercise that responsibility and do the right thing for all people in the county and demand that much more detail and consideration of these critical issues be provided, before any approval can be considered. Stop this process, now!

Alan Duguid

Little Bow 

June 01, 2026

From: [Crystal Rose](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026 - 007
Date: May 31, 2026 3:02:47 PM

Bylaw 2026 - 007

Written Submission to County of Vulcan on the proposed change to the land-use by law from agriculture to industrial near Lake McGregor.

I am writing as most of the county residents [who are informed] are concerned with the long-term impact of permitting a change of land use to industrial that would benefit only the AI consortium applying for the change.

It's common knowledge if you look at where the AI/Tech companies that are operating below the Canada-US border that there are many proven instances of how it is affecting their water quality and amounts, due to what is being used by the AI/tech companies for their purposes and the impacts on those communities. There is other concerns too like electricity cost, pollution, noise and other, but concerns about water quality and quantity seems to be the most concerning. There are literally thousands of current or proposed locations across the US and probably hundreds in Canada, including in our province that are dealing with the same situation as the County of Vulcan.

I'm sure in addition to the deep-pocketed, AI/Tech Company who are offering lucrative deals in exchange for passing this land-use change either to the County itself, the towns and villages within, even neighbouring landowners, none of which they care about and their false proclamations that they will be good stewards of the environment is quite frankly, BS. All you need to do is just look at what's happening in the US, where they have already gotten approval and built their AI centre and how residents are complaining that their water quality that was used can be equated to sludge! I'm sure they picked the area they did, thinking there would be little resistance to it and that rural area residents would be none the wiser, assuming they aren't as bright or schooled and that they are just simple farmers.

I'm sure the tech companies are proposing the land use change are telling the County of Vulcan that there won't be any change to water quality, use, etc., like they are everywhere else and thought there would be less resistance due to the fact it's just a little rural County in Southern Alberta. Unfortunately, any kind of company with deep pockets will use financial incentives and back room deals to sell what they want and figure the backlash will be minimal because it is less densely populated and figure there are less regulations in rural areas. Also unfortunate is if the county approves the land use designation change being proposed by the AI/Tech companies, it will be too late and the damage will have already been done and likely irreversible -- ie...water quality and quantity. Whereas, leaving the land use designation as agriculture will protect the waterway for generations to come, just like it has for generations. From what I seen of the map where the AI/Tech company is proposed the land use designation change, is right next to Lake McGregor. However the County of Vulcan wishes to

look at it, whether it be it's environment impact, tax base which is connected to tourism - the long-term impact is negative no matter which and the County needs to consider all of that. I'm sure the monies being promised by the big AI/Tech firm/s to the County or the current land owner/s, just like with the Wind Turbine Development - there is no long-term benefit to building and running this development as in addition to tourism being decimated once the safe water that currently resides in Lake McGregor is drained or turned to sludge by industrial use, especially with droughts also being a real concern, there also will no longer be tourism [boating, fishing, swimming] and not just near the cosway that runs through Lake McGregor where the Lake McGregor estates are [tourism and tax revenue dollars that will be lost] but at either end of the lake where provincial parks exist and also have built estates that border the water and provincial parks at Milo and Little Bow Park/Traver's, not to mention property values as no one will want to live or build in those areas once the long-term damage happens to the water quality and quantity if an industrial land use change is approved and a development goes ahead. And what about agriculture near by, I'm sure the AI/Tech Company that is proposing these changes is telling the County that no ill harm will come to them, but the farms downstream of this proposed development would be because even though for the most part they don't use or need the water from Lake McGregor, I'm sure some of them have livestock and/or fields nearby that if any was used to water them - won't be able to long-term [which will affect everyone including the farms/ranches and people in general].

From what I've seen on social media, they are just throwing these out there seeing what will stick and considering how many proposals they already either have in the pipeline or have been approved, including near Olds, Alberta, where citizens there are fighting as well, but for different reasons - they don't need to have the agriculture land use changed for this parcel of land changed to industrial, as it will cost landowners, tourists and the environment too much in the long run. Let them look somewhere else where they won't be as negative a toll on the environment footprint of the area.

I understand they already a landowner who is willing to sell the property they are after and I'm the offer is very lucrative for said landowner who doesn't care what's done to the land after it's sold and I'm sure if the land use proposal from agriculture to industrial is turned down by the County, then so does the lucrative land deal for the owner of said agricultural land.

Realizing that you, the County of Vulcan, has a big decision before you and I'm sure it's going to be a challenge, especially when the County stands to have all kinds of monies promised by this AI/Tech Company -- keep in mind, all the money in the world won't replace the water, the fish, the tourism, etc...once it's gone and it's left a negative environmental footprint that will affect the County of Vulcan and it's residents once the water is polluted or gone and can't be undone. It will affect your children, grandchildren and all the generations that come after it.

People, the County needs, not just want, NEED the water from Lake McGregor to remained untouched by industrial for generations to come as it will affect us all. Look what the US areas affected by AI/Tech companies building there or similar proposals are dealing with currently and look at what Environmentalist, Erin Brockovich is showing all of us what is

happening. No matter what this AI/Tech Company tells you -- this isn't the only place they can build, they can go somewhere else.

Myself and my family are one many, multi-generational, County of Vulcan residents/agriculture families who grew up in and around the Village of Lomond and are very proud of our roots [as well as years spent schooling, living and my father driving school bus for the County for the better part of 30+ years], including all of the agriculture land and also enjoyed Lake McGregor since it was Snake Lakes back in pioneer times and should have a say in land use designation that affects all of us, including the board that will vote on this. This is definitely one of the those, 'Not in my Backyard' times when the County should really use common sense and think long and hard about what allowing a land use change and this kind of development would have long-term, including for it's tax base, tourism and losing quality water that Lake McGregor has long provided to it's fish, swimming, skiing and boating and once that's gone, then what?

Not to mention it would be open season on agriculture land by other companies with similar interests, affecting agriculture moreso...and what about the infrastructure to house or feed these people, not the Town of Vulcan or any of it's towns or villages have infrastructure for that and even if, they brought their own trailers/tent cities, etc., the amount of litter, which will only compound the environmental damage, crime that always seems to accompany projects of this nature and trespassing by people on neighbouring lands isn't something I'm sure the County of Vulcan wants to see happen to it's residents. No matter what is promised, this AI/Tech company cannot give short or long-term assurances of what will or won't happen.

If the County this to go forward, they can't rewind and fix the damage and in all honesty, there are always unintended consequences of any action. Do you really believe the environment, IE. Lake McGregor and the people who not only enjoy the recreation of it and neighbouring towns, villages and land owners, whether recreational or agricultural should have to pay for those consequences in the long and short-term? Good luck trying to put the 'perverbial' rabbit back in the hat once it's out!

As you well know, people who live out in Rural Southern Alberta and the County of Vulcan are not uncivilized, uneducated people - no matter what they may think. This is not dark ages - we are in the 21st century and have all the modern conveniences we need, running water, electricity and most people even in the rural areas all have internet, cell phones and social media. I'm sure if a plebiscite was held on the matter rather than just letting the County of Vulcan rule on something that will have massive negative consequences, the answer from most residents would be to protect Lake McGregor and reject the proposed change to land use from agriculture to industrial - rejecting their application is the moral and common sense thing to do or have this company withdraw it's application. They chose this area, partly due to it's proximity to water than it requires to run it's cooling system, but also because they thought there would be little to no push back.

In the end, it all comes down to what is the right thing to do - not just for the environment, but County of Vulcan residents and all who enjoy Lake McGregor and rely on the recreation it offers. It affects all of us and no amount of money or investment from this AI Tech Firm will

replace the water and it's quality when it's gone for wildlife, agriculture, locals and tourists to enjoy for generations to come. Who benefits when the waters of Lake McGregor are no more?

Thank you.

From: [Douglas Evans](#)
To: [Jason Schneider](#); [Doug Logan](#); [Laurie Lyckman](#); [Alex Horkoff](#); [Alena Matlock](#); [Lansey Middleton](#); [Kelly Nelson](#); [Christopher Northcott](#); [Jodie Gateman](#); [Nels Petersen](#)
Subject: Objection to Bylaw 2026-007
Date: May 31, 2026 3:36:53 PM
Attachments: [Vulcan County Objection Letter 0001.pdf](#)

Please see attached Letter of objection to the Land use use bylaw 2026-007 for the change in zoning from Rural General to Rural Industrial

Sincerely:

Doug & Brenda Evans

■ Sunset Drive

Little Bow Resort, AB

To: County of Vulcan Council

May 31, 2026

Subject: Letter of Objection – Proposed Palliser Grid AI Data Centre Campus Bylaw 2026-007

Dear Members of Council,

My wife and I have resided in Vulcan County at Little Bow Resort since 2008 (18 years). We initially purchased our lot at Little Bow in 2003 and with the help of family and friends we built the home we are living in today. Some marvel at the concept that an Accountant could achieve such a feat!

We lived and worked in Calgary most of our lives and raised three children there. Working in the oil industry, we were exposed to the numerous cyclical of feast and famine that is known to plague this industry. We managed to survive through all of this and we were finally rewarded with the ability to retire. We decided to abandon the hectic city life and move to Vulcan County for a healthy simple lifestyle. We were attracted to Little Bow because of the fresh air, the quietness, the beauty of the rolling prairie, a pristine lake that not only supplies our drinking water but also offers year-round recreation (a uniqueness to most southern Alberta lakes), the abundance of various bird and other wildlife species, and the wide-open sky where you can view the stars and even the auroras.

The lifestyle that we worked all of our lives to achieve is now in jeopardy because of the rezoning Bylaw 2026-007, for the purpose to redesignate Section 14 and portions of E1/2 15-15-21 W4 from "Rural General - RG" to "Rural Industrial - RI". If this land use bylaw is passed it will be developed into an AI data processing campus. We are deeply concerned about the negative impact that an AI data processing campus will have on the environment, including light pollution, noise pollution, lake water quality, and the loss of visual aesthetics by having to view an industrial site instead of rolling farmland.

We have been alarmed over the last few years with the growth in industrial use of the land surrounding our home in Little Bow Resort. The Blackspring Ridge Wind Farm, Traverse Solar Farm, and Buffalo Plains Wind Farm; all of which have been built with minimal or no consultation with Little Bow Resort. Promised community financial benefits from these project developers to Little Bow Resort have never materialized. If this rezoning Bylaw is passed, we fear it will open the floodgates to additional industrial development and loss of valuable farmland.

Another major concern is that in the case that we have a serious emergency occurring on the site of the AI Data campus and we are required to evacuate our premises quickly, we have only one road on which to exit. This takes us to the intersection of Highway 529 and Range Rd. 212, exactly where the potential emergency was initiated.

Mr. Steeves has presented that the land that he would like to have rezoned industrial is poorly suited for farming and he has stated this has been so for five generations. It does not make any sense to me why five generations would continue to farm a piece of property that does not provide any good returns. Also, I noticed that this property has again been seeded for the current crop year.

We understand that there is a need for these types of data centers and we are not opposed to their development. But there are many other sites, even within Vulcan County that would be more suitable providing minimal environmental and human impact. We appreciate the goals and ambitions presented by Mr. Steeves. However, for him to be successful he has the ability to potentially destroy the lifestyle that took us a lifetime to build.

We are therefore requesting that Vulcan County Council not pass Bylaw 2026-007.

I also request that this correspondence be included in the official record for Bylaw 2026-007.

Kindest Regards:

  Brenda Evans

Doug & Brenda Evans

■ Sunset Drive, Little Bow Resort. AB

CC: Jason Schneider, Reeve, Division 3

Doug Logan, Division 7

Jodie Gateman, Division 1

Alex Horkoff, Division 2

Laurie Lyckman, Division 4

Kelly Nelson, Division 5

Christopher Northcott, Division 6

Nels Petersen, Chief Administrative Officer

Lansey Middleton, Manager of Legislative Services

Alena Matlock, Development Officer

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From: [Joanne Bean](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Proposed Data Centre
Date: June 1, 2026 11:52:21 AM

[REDACTED]

I am adamantly opposed to the development of farm land to become a data centre.
With consideration for the environment, water and electric demand having detrimental effects on community health, and property values.
We are in a semi arid region, with high risk of fires. With dry conditions most of the year, and increased heat and climate effects by these data centres, this could be disastrous for the region.
It would set a dangerous precedent for future land use choices.
There is not an abundance of water in vulcan county as it is.
Short term greed for long term destruction of environment and general health and livelihood is not worth it. Many land owners have farmed their land for generations.
Money cannot be eaten!

Joanne Bean RMT

[REDACTED]

From: [Julia Rooks](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026 - 007
Date: May 29, 2026 9:45:01 PM

Dear Members of Council,

I am writing to formally oppose Bylaw 2026-007 and the proposed redesignation of approximately 850 acres of land from Rural General to Rural Industrial to facilitate a large-scale data centre development near Travers Reservoir and Little Bow Resort.

My family purchased at Little Bow because we fell in love with the area. What stood out to us was how scenic, quiet, and charming it was compared to so many other places. It felt like a hidden gem close to Calgary where we could escape the city for a few days, spend time on the boat, enjoy the outdoors, and make memories with our kids. Southern Alberta has so few lakes and recreational areas, and finding a small, intimate lake community like this felt incredibly special.

That is why I am so concerned about this proposal.

Little Bow and the surrounding reservoir area are valued because they are quiet, rural, and recreational in nature. A project of this scale would permanently change the character of the area. Once industrial zoning is approved, there is no realistic way to get that character back.

My concerns include:

- Continuous industrial noise associated with 24-hour operations, cooling infrastructure, and backup power systems.
- Significant visual impacts, including large industrial buildings, electrical infrastructure, security fencing, and nighttime lighting.
- Increased traffic and pressure on local roads during both construction and ongoing operations.
- Water consumption and environmental impacts associated with a development of this magnitude, particularly given its proximity to Travers Reservoir, wetlands, and other environmentally sensitive areas.
- The precedent this rezoning would set for future industrial expansion in an area that has historically been agricultural, recreational, and residential in nature.
- The fact that such a major zoning change is being considered before the public has a clear understanding of all long-term impacts related to noise, water use, traffic, and environmental effects.

While I support responsible economic development, I do not believe this is the right location for a project of this scale. There are other areas that are better suited for industrial development and that would have far less impact on residents, visitors, property owners, and

the recreational value of the reservoir.

What concerns me most is that this project appears fundamentally incompatible with the reasons people choose to live, vacation, and invest in this area. Many of us have spent significant time and money building a place where our families can disconnect from the city and enjoy the peace and natural beauty of the lake. An industrial data centre complex is simply not consistent with that vision.

I respectfully request that Council reject Bylaw 2026-007. At a minimum, I urge Council to defer any decision until comprehensive and independently reviewed studies have been completed and the public has had a full opportunity to review and understand the implications of this proposal.

Thank you for your consideration. Please include this letter as part of the official record for the June 10, 2026 public hearing.

Sincerely,

Julia Rooks

██████ Lakeside Dr

From: [Lynne Allan](#)
To: [Jason Schneider](#); [Doug Logan](#); [Jodie Gateman](#); [Alex Horkoff](#); [Laurie Lyckman](#); [Kelly Nelson](#); [Christopher Northcott](#); [Nels Petersen](#); [Lansey Middleton](#); [Alena Matlock](#); [Lynne and Bruce Allan](#)
Subject: Date Correction - Objection To Proposed Land Use Bylaw Rezone Rural General To Rural Industrial To Facilitate Construction Of An AI Data Centre Near Hwy529/RR212 Intersection
Date: May 30, 2026 10:08:04 AM

Find below correspondence previously emailed April 9, 2026 resubmitted for consideration at the June 10, 2026 Public Hearing at Champion Community Hall commencing at 1:00 pm confirming our objection to Bylaw 2026-007 Proposed Land Use Bylaw Rezone From Rural General To Rural Industrial

May 30, 2026 (Via E-Mail)

To: Members Of Vulcan County Council & Administration

Jason Schneider, Reeve, Division 3 Doug Logan, Division 7 Jodie Gateman, Division 1 Alex Horkoff, Division 2 Laurie Lyckman, Division 4 Kelly Nelson, Division 5 Christopher Northcott, Division 6 Nels Petersen, Chief Administrative Officer Lansey Middleton, Manager of Legislative Services Alena Matlock, Development Officer jason.schneider@vulcan.ca doug.logan@vulcan.ca jodie.gateman@vulcan.ca alex.horkoff@vulcan.ca laurie.lyckman@vulcan.ca kelly.nelson@vulcan.ca christopher.northcott@vulcan.ca cao@vulcancounty.ab.ca ea@vulcancounty.ab.ca devassist@vulcancounty.ab.ca

Re: Consideration Of Bylaw 2026-007 Proposed Land Use Bylaw Rezone Rural General To Rural Industrial To Facilitate Construction Of An AI Data Centre

Dear Sir/Madam:

We submit this correspondence as our formal objection to the proposed Land Use Bylaw Rezone Rural General To Rural Industrial to facilitate the construction of an AI Data Centre in the vicinity of the Highway 529 and Range Road 212 intersection. AI Data Centres are known

to consume massive amounts of water which is in short supply in Alberta in general, and particularly in southern Alberta where drought conditions exist presently and in all likelihood will exist in future.

We are not anti development if development is managed responsibly, but feel the addition of the proposed AI Data Centre is not responsible development in an already water challenged area. While tax revenue and employment opportunities look attractive with any development, any benefit from an AI Data Centre are far outweighed by the risk(s) associated with lack of water to existing and future stakeholders. We have witnessed Travers Reservoir at low levels in years past and adding a massive water consumer such as an AI Data Centre to the current water stressors is simply not responsible government.

We ask that as elected representatives you make decisions to the benefit of all constituents and reject any change to the current land use designation thereby minimizing the water challenges that will exist in future even without the addition of an AI Data Centre.

Best Regards;

Bruce & Lynne Allan

 Vista Crescent

Little Bow Resort

Hello, I am writing this letter to express my deep concerns over the rezoning of a parcel of land near Little Bow Resort to a rural industrial zone. I am a part time resident of Little Bow Resort since 2002, with the intention of living at my home (Willow Lane) on a more permanent basis once I retire. LBR has been a joyful, peaceful place that means a great deal to me, my children grandchildren, family & friends. I have invested a great deal of money in my property to establish a place for myself, my family for years & hopefully generations to come. There have been many changes over the last several years with regards to the surrounding area of LBR. I am concerned about the cumulative impacts of the wind turbines, solar farms & now quite possibly an AI Data centre. This is not what I envisioned when I bought property in Vulcan county all these years ago. let me be clear, I'm not adverse to creating renewable resource opportunities, but this whole AI Data centre feels like a whole different ballgame, with far reaching & somewhat unknown complications & impact.

Here are some of concerns & questions:

1. What percentage of water will be taken from the lake on a daily basis? How much will this vary when it's -30 below or +30 above?
2. The possible addition of the AI Data centre will greatly change the aesthetics of the landscape of the whole lake.
3. What happens to the consumption of water when we are experiencing a drought? We've had to conserve water in the past, will they have to as well. The predictions of the climate in Southern Alberta is that we will be getting drier & drier as time goes on, makes no sense to have a centre that will be drawing a lot of water.
4. It was very disappointing to find out that the proposal for the rezoning was found on a Facebook post, not very official. Considering we are under 2 miles from the proposed site I would have hoped that the County of Vulcan would have shown us more respect Perhaps in the future you will have a quick & better dialogue with LBR as we have been a part of this County since 1993. We are property tax paying residents who deserved more than the absolute bare minimum notice.
5. What happens in the case of a fire? LBR has only one way in & one way out, we could very much be put in harms way & have a tragedy on our hands if a fire breaks out at the centre. There are only volunteer fire departments in the area. Not only do we not have quick response multiple fire departments, what about the amount of water to put out a fire?
6. I'm very concerned about the significant sound mottling that we will experience due to our close proximity to

the lake. How will this not only affect humans, but what about the birds & the wildlife?

7. I worry about all the construction workers during the build, where will they live? Will it be like the solar panel project where they were in our community or just campers on farm land. The more people in & around LBR that are not home owners creates a potential for them entering our community to access the lake. Often with transient workers there can be an uptick in theft & vandalism. How will we be protected?

8. I am concerned about the traffic safety & disruptions of our highways/roadways.

9. The proposed land designation change fails to address the cumulative impacts on water, noise, light pollution and air quality.

10. If the Data centre ends up being shut down for some reason & is no longer functioning , what are the reclamation plans, who will be responsible, who will pay, & will the company honour the agreement or not care like the Oil & Gas companies?

11. The Albert government has passed legislation to limit renewable energy infrastucture to protect the natural beauty of the Alberta landscape. It would seem that an AI Data centre would not be in the best interest of protection the natural beauty.

12. There is a paper coming out soon from the University of Cambridge that measure the temperature of nearby areas where AI Data centres have been built. In a 6.2mile radius of the building they found "heat islands" with an average tempera increase of 3.6 degrees & in extreme cases 16.4 degree increases. Very concerning with great environmental impacts.

I recognize that the rezoning of this farm land creates a large financial benefit to the county especially if a AI Data centre is part of the mix, which will undoubtedly bend most council members to approve this proposal. As climate change takes a bigger hold on the environment with its unrelenting power we need to seriously look at the impact of building AI Data centres & their strain & drain on our land.

Please reconsider accepting this proposal or at the very least delay the decision until all the necessary research & data can be made available to those who are making the decisions.

Thank you for your time, perhaps I will hear from you.

Take care,
Marcia Woodman

From: [Pam Zach](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026-007 Public Hearing - Written Submission
Date: May 31, 2026 6:49:01 PM
Attachments: [June 10 2026 - letter of opposition Bylaw 2026-007 Public Hearing.docx](#)

Good evening,

Please find attached my written submission to be included in public hearing package, and presented to council and administration for consideration at the public hearing on June 10, 2026, for the public hearing of the proposed bylaw No 2026-007.

Also, could you please confirm that you have received my letter, as attached.

Thank you very much,

Pam Zacharias

Vulcan County Council
Box 180, 102 Centre Street
Vulcan, Alberta
T0L 2B0

Mrs. Pam Zacharias
[REDACTED] Lakeside Drive
Vulcan County, Alberta
[REDACTED]

May 31, 2026

RE: Bylaw 2026-007 Public Hearing

Dear Reeve and Councillors,

I am writing to formally express my **opposition to the proposed bylaw 2026-007** and my opposition to the redesignation of approximately 350 ha of section 14 and portions of E1/2 15-15-21 W4 from Rural General to Rural Industrial. I am a Vulcan County Taxpayer with a year-round residential property at [REDACTED] Lakeside Drive [REDACTED]).

While I recognize the pressures for controlled and thoughtful land development, I believe this particular project and land redesignation raises serious concerns that would result in **irreversible negative impacts** that outweigh any potential benefits to our community.

First, the **environmental impact** of additional industrial development so close to a substantial water resource (i.e. traverse reservoir) and wildlife habitat is significant. Industrial infrastructure has the potential to require extreme amounts of water resources while emitting substantial pollution and industrial waste. The traverse reservoir already struggles to sustain adequate water resources for agriculture, ecosystems, local wildlife, and residents. Furthermore, the county must consider the likelihood of soil degradation, public health risks, and community hazards. The imbalance between the project's large environmental footprint does not come close to outweighing the limited benefit of increased tax dollars. It is important to remember that these substantial environmental impacts cannot be reversed and will impact our future generations.

Second, industrial infrastructure is often extremely energy-intensive and places **substantial demand on electrical grids** and increasing demand for non-renewable energy sources. We are a community that already experiences significant demands on our electricity grid, including frequent power outages throughout the year.

Third, there are **legitimate concerns related to land use, noise, and overall quality of life** for adjacent landowners and residential communities. Redesignating this agricultural

land opens up the opportunity for substantial industrial development that will very likely result in constant industrial noise, increased heavy-truck traffic, air and water pollutants, increased ambient air temperatures, and the negative visual impact that will substantially impact nearby landowners, wildlife, and residents. In addition, this would create increased risk of fire which would be extremely difficult to contain in the event of an emergency, while placing adjacent residents at unnecessary risk. Furthermore, these cumulative negative effects will reduce property values and alter the character of the county and surrounding community.

Finally, I am extremely concerned about **the pace at which this proposal is being advanced relative to public consultation**. To date, the developer has not yet initiated any meaningful public consultation to address significant warranted concerns of residents and taxpayers. Projects of this scale and consequence require robust engagement with residents, transparent disclosure of environmental and infrastructure impacts, and binding commitments.

The location of this rural industrial development is very concerning and will substantially impact the landscape, wildlife, environment, and residents. If the designation of land is approved, there is very little option to reverse or halt industrial development in the future. For these reasons, I urge you to reject this proposal.

Regards,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, appearing to read "Pam Zacharias".

Pam Zacharias
Vulcan County Taxpayer

From: [Rosemary S](#)
To: [Jason Schneider](#); [Jodie Gateman](#); alex.hartkoff@vulcan.ca; [Laurie Lyckman](#); [Kelly Nelson](#); corey.logan@vulcan.ca; christoher.northcott@vulcan.ca; [Nels Petersen](#); [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: County of Vulcan Council - Public Hearing for Bylaw 2026-007 June 9 Objection
Date: May 31, 2026 2:40:01 PM

I am writing to voice my deep opposition to the above proposal being heard in Champion on June 9. There are several factors influencing my feelings:

1. The land use designation change does not recognize the hundreds of years of contributions the agriculture industry has made to our province and country. Ignoring that and focusing on removing agriculture land from the farming and ranching industry to put it into industrial use is short-sighted, negligent and could lead to any number of industrial uses which will negatively affect the land itself, the environment, the residents of Vulcan and the County of Vulcan at large, and most importantly, the farmers and ranchers surrounding that parcel.
2. Any industrial use of that parcel will necessitate environmental damage to the dwindling and now endangered short-grass prairie and the creatures who live on the prairie land. There will be more road construction, more building construction, drains on the power grid, more heavy traffic on the roads, noise, light pollution, and risk of accidents.
3. Any industrial use will necessitate significantly more use of water, which is also becoming a scarce resource in this part of the province.
4. Fire is an increasingly present hazard; using up scarce water resources and building industrial structures in the middle of a drought area presents a danger to humans and animals, and threatened loss of agriculture land to fire.
5. As a resident of Little Bow Resort, and having paid taxes and faithfully supported local County of Vulcan businesses and services for 25 years, I am now being threatened with loss of enjoyment of my property and likely diminished value of that property. It is a deep betrayal of the community of residents of Little Bow Resort by the County of Vulcan.
6. Moving the original bylaw meeting to Champion, and thus invalidating all the submissions presented, or wanting to present, at the original bylaw meeting in Vulcan, presents as an underhanded denigration of the electorate of the county.

It means it will be difficult for citizens of the town of Vulcan to attend the meeting. It speaks volumes about the lack of respect this council has for the electorate and their opinions on such a significant change to land use in the County of Vulcan.

Rosemary Simpson
[REDACTED] Lakeside Drive
Little Bow Resort

From: [Nels Petersen](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: FW: Objection To Proposed Bylaw 2026-007 Rezoning Application.
Date: June 1, 2026 9:14:33 AM
Attachments: [Land Rezoning Letter 2.pdf](#)

I see this submission had your email misspelled.

Nels

From: Ross/Colleen Clements [REDACTED]
Sent: June 1, 2026 9:11 AM
To: Lansey Middleton <ea@vulcancounty.ab.ca>
Cc: Jason Schneider <Jason.Schneider@vulcan.ca>; Doug Logan <doug.logan@vulcan.ca>; Jodie Gateman <jodie.gateman@vulcan.ca>; Alex Horkoff <alex.horkoff@vulcan.ca>; Laurie Lyckman <laurie.lyckman@vulcan.ca>; Kelly Nelson <kelly.nelson@vulcan.ca>; Christopher Northcott <christopher.northcott@vulcan.ca>; Nels Petersen <cao@vulcancounty.ab.ca>; devassist@vulaccounty.ab.ca; Tim Stewart <tstewart@hometimecanada.com>
Subject: Objection To Proposed Bylaw 2026-007 Rezoning Application.

[REDACTED]

Attached is our objection to proposed bylaw 2026-007 which proposes to rezone certain lands to pave the way to develop an AI Data Centre.

Tim - please forward this letter to the Little Bow Resort AI Data Centre Committee and any other interested owners. Thanks

Colleen & Ross Clements

Colleen & Ross Clements
[REDACTED] *Lakeside Drive*
Little Bow Resort, Vulcan County, AB
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

County of Vulcan Council

Attention: Councilors and Managers

Delivered VIA email: ea@vulcancounty.ab.ca

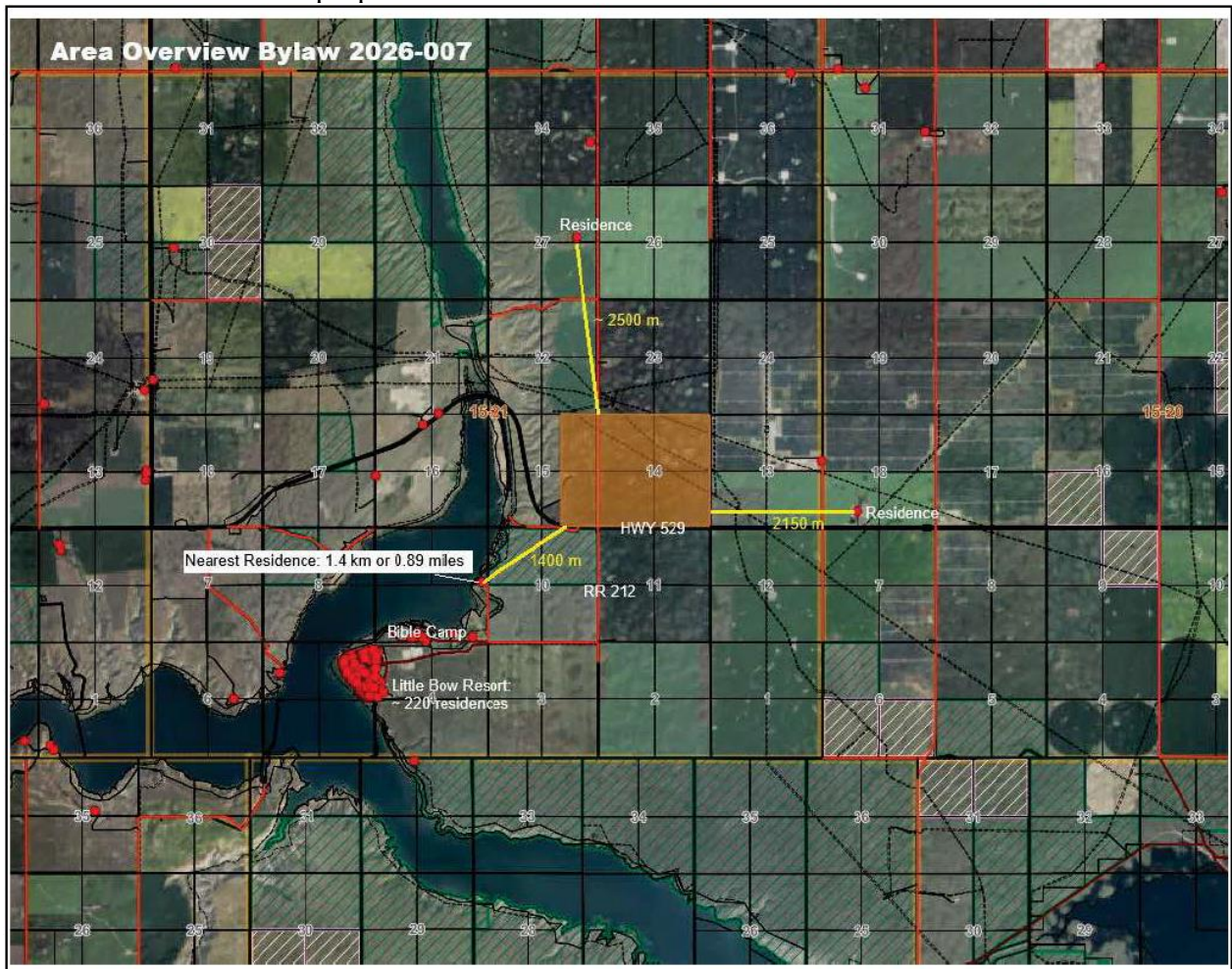
June 1, 2026

Dear Councilors and Managers:

Re: Objection To Proposed Bylaw 2026-007 Rezoning Application

Non-Compliance With Bylaws

The following map is contained in the Notice of Public Hearing on page 20 of 128, showing distances from the lands proposed to be rezoned to residences and the Traverse Reservoir:



Vulcan County Land Use Bylaw No. 2020-028, Schedule 2 – RI, Section 13.1 states:

SECTION 13 INDUSTRIAL SITING STANDARDS

- 13.1** A proposed grouped industrial development or an isolated industrial development considered by the Development Authority to be potentially hazardous, unsightly or offensive should not be approved within 1.6 km (1 mile) of:
- (a) an incorporated urban municipality;
 - (b) a hamlet;
 - (c) a provincial, regional, municipal park or recreation area;
 - (d) an environmentally significant area;
 - (e) an existing or approved rural residence.

The proposed industrial development is potentially hazardous, unsightly and offensive to all but one of the residents that attended the April 1, 2026 hearing. The proposed development is within 1.6 km of a provincial, regional, municipal park or recreation area, within 1.6 km of an environmentally significant area, within 1.6 km of an existing rural residence and within 1.6 km of an approved rural residence.

Why is this application even being considered when it clearly contravenes section 13.1 for Rural Industrial land use?

In order for the proposed development to happen, the developer would also need to secure a shoreline lease on the shoreline of the Traverse Reservoir and build a water intake system which would include large water intake pipes anchored several hundred feet out into the reservoir, several high volume pumps sitting on the shore, large diameter water line pipes buried underground up the hill to supply water to the proposed Data Centre 24 hours a day. Based on information contained in the proposal, the Data Centre could consume up to 24,000,000 litres of water a day, approximately 4.8% of the daily water consumption in the City of Calgary.

$0.5 \text{ litres / kwh} \times 2,000,000 \text{ kw/hr} \times 24 \text{ hours/day} = 24,000,000 \text{ litres/day}$
City of Calgary water consumption 500,000,000 litres / day
(see attached calculations)

The shoreline lease and pumping station are critical infrastructure to this proposed development, and likely for many other RI designated land use projects that may be considered in the future, so the proximity tests of less than 1.6 km stated above (13.1 (a) to (e)) should be measured from the location of the pumping station that would sit beside the spillway on the shoreline, making this project further non-compliant with section 13.1 of the Bylaw.

The County cannot legally rezone this land to RI. Rezoning this land to RI would contravene Vulcan County Land Use Bylaw No. 2020-028, Schedule 2 – RI, Section 13.1

We hereby demand that the County of Vulcan immediately cease pursuing rezoning these lands to RI, to avoid damages to nearby land owners that would most certainly occur if the lands were rezoned to RI in contravention of Land Use Bylaws.

AI Data Centre - Water Usage Estimates

Water Usage Effectiveness (WUE) Target in Application is 0.1 to 0.5 litres / kwh

Range of l/kwh for original 1,220 MW IT plan		0.10	0.50
Phase 1 (500 MW = 500,000 kw)			
Litres per hour		50,000	250,000
Litres per day (24 hours)		1,200,000	6,000,000
<i>Typical daily water consumption for a 500 MW AI Data Centre - Evaporative Cooling (AI Enquiry)</i>		<i>4,000,000</i>	<i>10,000,000</i>
<i>Typical daily water consumption for a 500 MW AI Data Centre - Closed Loop System (AI Enquiry)</i>		<i>1,500,000</i>	<i>2,500,000</i>
All 4 Phases			
Litres per hour		200,000	1,000,000
Litres per day (24 hours)		4,800,000	24,000,000
Litres per year		1,752,000,000	8,760,000,000
Acre Ft			
1 acre = 43,560 sq ft			
Litres per sq ft = 28.32			
Litres per acre ft		1,233,482	
All 4 Phases			
Acre Ft per day water consumption		4	19
Acre Ft per year water consumption		1,420	7,102
Acre Ft per year - each phase		355	1,775
City of Calgary total water usage per day = 500,000,000 litres			
AI Data Centre water usage % of Calgary		0.96%	4.80%
Traverse Reservoir Volume = 326,410 cubic decameters			
Litres		326,410,000,000	
AI Data Centre Estimated Water Consumption % of Traverse Reservoir volume (all 4 phases)			
		0.54%	2.68%

Yours Truly,

Colleen Clements

Cc;

Jason Schneider, Reeve, Division 3

Doug Logan, Division 7

Jodie Gateman, Division 1

Alex Horkoff, Division 2

Laurie Lyckman, Division 4

Kelly Nelson, Division 5

Christopher Northcott, Division 6

Nels Petersen, Chief Administrative Officer

Lansey Middleton, Manager of Legislative Services

Alena Matlock, Development Officer

Ross Clements

jason.schneider@vulcan.ca

doug.logan@vulcan.ca

jodie.gateman@vulcan.ca

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laurie.lyckman@vulcan.ca

kelly.nelson@vulcan.ca

christopher.northcott@vulcan.ca

cao@vulcancounty.ab.ca

ea@vulcancounty.ab.ca

devassist@vulcancounty.ab.ca

Property Owners at Little Bow Resort

From: [Zabrina Letourneau](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Re: Opposition to Proposed Bylaw No. 2026-007 – Land Use Redesignation from Rural General to Rural Industrial
Date: May 30, 2026 12:59:52 PM

To: Vulcan County Council
Re: Proposed Bylaw No. 2026-007

Dear Members of Council,

I am writing to formally oppose **Proposed Bylaw No. 2026-007**, which would redesignate land from **Rural General** to **Rural Industrial**.

While I recognize the importance of economic development and job creation, I believe this proposed land use change raises significant concerns regarding environmental protection, agricultural preservation, infrastructure demands, and the long-term well-being of surrounding rural communities.

Loss of Valuable Agricultural Land

Vulcan County's agricultural lands are among its most valuable and irreplaceable resources. Once farmland is converted to industrial use, it is rarely returned to productive agricultural purposes. The loss of agricultural land:

- Reduces local food production capacity.
- Impacts the long-term sustainability of farming operations in the region.
- Contributes to the fragmentation of agricultural areas, making farming less efficient.
- Reduces opportunities for future generations to utilize productive farmland.
- Undermines the agricultural character and economic foundation upon which much of Vulcan County has been built.

At a time when food security is becoming an increasingly important issue, preserving productive farmland should remain a priority.

Environmental Concerns

Industrial development can have substantial environmental impacts that differ greatly from traditional agricultural use. Concerns include:

- Increased risk of soil contamination from fuels, chemicals, lubricants, and industrial activities.
- Potential impacts to groundwater quality and aquifers.
- Increased stormwater runoff due to buildings, pavement, and compacted surfaces.
- Loss of natural vegetation and wildlife habitat.
- Increased dust, noise, and air pollution affecting nearby residents and livestock.
- Greater greenhouse gas emissions associated with industrial operations and increased transportation activity.

Rural areas provide important ecological functions that can be permanently altered by industrial development.

Excessive Water Demand

Industrial developments often require significantly more water than agricultural or rural residential uses.

Potential concerns include:

- Increased pressure on local groundwater resources.
- Competition for water resources used by farms, livestock operations, and rural residents.
- Increased wastewater generation and associated disposal concerns.
- Potential impacts on future water availability during drought conditions.

Given Southern Alberta's history of water shortages and drought cycles, any development requiring substantial water consumption deserves careful scrutiny.

Increased Electrical Infrastructure Demands

Industrial operations typically require substantial electrical service upgrades and ongoing power consumption.

This can result in:

- Additional infrastructure requirements across rural landscapes.
- Increased transmission and distribution facilities.
- Visual impacts from utility infrastructure.
- Greater energy consumption and associated environmental impacts.
- Potential future costs that may ultimately affect taxpayers and ratepayers.

Council should carefully consider whether existing infrastructure can sustainably support industrial-scale development.

Impacts on Surrounding Rural Communities

Residents choose rural areas because of their agricultural character, open spaces, lower traffic volumes, and quieter lifestyle.

Industrial development can negatively affect neighboring properties through:

- Increased heavy truck traffic.
- Road wear and increased maintenance costs.
- Traffic safety concerns for local residents, school buses, and farm equipment.
- Noise from industrial operations and transportation.
- Increased dust and lighting impacts.
- Reduced enjoyment of rural properties.
- Potential decreases in nearby property values.
- Conflicts between industrial activities and existing agricultural operations.

These impacts can extend well beyond the boundaries of the proposed site and affect multiple surrounding communities.

Precedent for Future Development

Approving this redesignation may establish a precedent for additional industrial rezoning requests in the future. Over time, incremental approvals can significantly alter the character of rural areas and erode the agricultural land base.

Council should carefully evaluate whether this proposal aligns with the County's long-term planning objectives and commitment to preserving agricultural lands.

Conclusion

For the reasons outlined above—including the loss of productive farmland, environmental concerns, increased water and electrical demands, impacts on neighboring communities, traffic concerns, and the long-term implications for rural land use—I respectfully request that Vulcan County Council reject Proposed Bylaw No. 2026-007.

I encourage Council to prioritize the protection of agricultural lands, environmental stewardship, and the interests of existing rural residents when considering this application.

Thank you for your consideration of my comments.

Respectfully submitted,

Zabrina Letourneau

■ Sunset Drive

Little Bow Resort, Vulcan County.

■

From: [Charlene Hjorleifson](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026-007 Public hearing
Date: June 2, 2026 2:58:15 PM

To Vulcan County Council members,

I'm writing to officially oppose the rezoning of rural to industrial AI data centre.

While I support economic development and technological advancement, this proposal raises serious concerns that require thorough review before any rezoning approval.

1. Scale of the Development

The campus represents an unprecedented industrial project for our region, with up to 2,000 MW of IT load, making it one of Canada's largest data centres. Rezoning agricultural land for such a facility would drastically alter the area's character and set a concerning precedent for future industrial expansion near Travers Reservoir.

2. Water Use and Long-Term Sustainability

The project plans to draw water from Travers Reservoir. The submission lacks clear details on:

- Total annual water demand.
- Water lost through evaporation and other processes.
- Reservoir impacts during drought.
- Long-term effects on agriculture, recreation, and ecosystems.

Water is a scarce resource in Southern Alberta. Residents deserve a detailed, independently reviewed assessment of the facility's water needs and potential impacts before rezoning is considered.

3. Infrastructure and Utility Impacts

The development requires extensive electrical infrastructure, including transmission lines and a large substation. Residents need clarity on:

- The full infrastructure footprint.
- Impacts on surrounding lands.
- Cumulative effects of transmission, substations, battery storage, and backup generation.

4. Environmental and Public Safety Concerns

The proposal includes:

- 5 million litres of diesel storage.
- Emergency backup generators.
- Large-scale battery storage.

These raise environmental and safety risks that must be fully assessed. Residents need assurance that spill prevention, fire protection, emergency response, and mitigation measures are robust. Additionally, the application does not address waste heat generation and its potential effects on local temperatures, agriculture, microclimates, or water evaporation. An independent assessment is essential.

5. Traffic, Construction, and Community Impacts

Construction could involve up to 1,000 workers and heavy truck traffic, affecting:

- Local roads and transportation.
- Noise and air quality.
- Rural residents' quality of life.

A comprehensive, publicly reviewed impact assessment is necessary before rezoning.

6. Limited Permanent Employment Relative to Project Size

Despite its massive footprint, the project would create only about 200 permanent jobs. The long-term community benefits appear insufficient to justify the significant land, water, power, and infrastructure impacts.

Given these concerns, I respectfully request that council reject the proposed rezoning and development approvals.

I thank you for your time and consideration in this matter.

Charlene & Brian Hjørleifson

████ Lakeside Drive,
Little Bow Resort
████

Sent from my iPhone

From: [Clint Walls](#)
To: [Doug Logan](#); [Jodie Gateman](#); [Laurie Lyckman](#); [Kelly Nelson](#); [Christopher Northcott](#); [Lansey Middleton](#); [Nels Petersen](#); [Alex Horkoff](#); [Alena Matlock](#); [Jason Schneider](#)
Subject: Re: Objection To Proposed Bylaw 2026-007 Rezoning Application
Date: June 2, 2026 3:19:55 PM
Attachments: [Little Bow Speaking notes.docx](#)
[LBR Redesignation.docx](#)


Please review the attachments regarding my objection to the proposed bylaw 2026-007

Clint Walls
 Sunset Drive
Little Bow Resort

Speaker: Clint Walls

Re: Bylaw 2026-007 (Rezoning to Rural Industrial)

"Good afternoon Reeve Schneider, Council, and Administration. My name is **Clint Walls**, and I am a resident of **██████████ Sunset Drive, Little Bow Resort**.

I am standing here today to strictly oppose Bylaw 2026-007. While we understand the County's desire for economic development, placing a **2000 Megawatt** heavy industrial facility next to a recreational resort and a critical irrigation reservoir is a fundamental failure of land-use planning. This is not 'Rural Industrial' development; it is the urbanization of a delicate agricultural corridor. This is not the right area for a project of this scale and classification.

"First, let's talk about the scale of **water** consumption. A 2000 MW data center is not a passive warehouse; it is a thirsty machine. Industry data indicates that hyperscale facilities of this magnitude can consume **tens of millions of liters of water daily** for cooling. To put that in perspective, that rivals the daily water consumption of a small city. Where is this water going to come from?

We are living through a period of historic drought volatility in Southern Alberta. Does it make planning sense to attach a water license of this magnitude to the Travers Reservoir—the lifeblood of our local irrigation districts and recreation—when we cannot guarantee levels for existing users?"

"Second, is the issue of **noise** compatibility. Data centers emit a constant, low-frequency mechanical 'hum' from cooling fans and substations that is proven to travel miles over open water and flat prairie.

This is not the intermittent noise of a tractor; it is a 24/7 industrial drone.

There would be light pollution and air quality changes as well.

Residents of Little Bow Resort invested here for the quiet enjoyment of nature.

Rezoning this land destroys that primary asset. If this Bylaw passes, you are effectively deciding that the industrial 'hum' takes precedence over the residential and recreational viability of the resort." There is a very real concern about a decline in property values and the enjoyment of the lifestyle that each resident has bought into.

Due to the rural nature of this area, there is a larger land area that is affected than what would be affected if we were more urban. Little Bow is affected by this proposed development because the site is at the corner of the only way that we can get in or out. If there were a fire at that site, it would effectively block us in and remove our only means of getting to safety.

"Finally, this rezoning sets a dangerous precedent. If we allow heavy industry on this parcel, we signal that the entire Little Bow corridor is open for industrialization. This land is currently zoned 'Rural General' for a reason: to buffer our agricultural and recreational

assets. Changing it now benefits one corporation at the expense of the entire community's future."

I am concerned that some of the due processes weren't properly handled, such as notice requirements required by the Municipal Government Act. If these aren't being handled properly now and we set this precedent, I am worried about what else will be allowed in the area that will further decrease my investment.

"In conclusion, the wrong project in the wrong place is not progress—it's a mistake. We urge Council to vote **AGAINST** Bylaw 2026-007 and direct this development to an established industrial park where it belongs. Thank you."

Opposition to Redesignation of Agricultural Land to Industrial Use - Lake McGregor to Travers Dam Corridor

Clint Walls

■ Sunset Drive, Little Bow Resort

June 2, 2026

To: Vulcan County Council and Planning Department / Reeve Schneider

Re: Environmental Hazards Posed by Industrial Rezoning in the Lake McGregor - Travers Reservoir - Little Bow Waterway Corridor

This letter formally identifies the critical environmental corridor hazards associated with redesignating land from **Agriculture** to **Industrial** use along the waterway extending from Lake McGregor south to Travers Dam, specifically impacting the Little Bow Resort area.

Based on the sensitive ecological profile of the Carseland-Bow River Headworks System, introducing industrial land use into this restrictive "Reservoir Vicinity" introduces the following direct hazards:

1. Critical Shoreline Instability and Erosion Acceleration

The shoreline of Lake McGregor is already geologically unstable, currently eroding at a rate of approximately **one metre per year** due to wave action and wind. [1]

- **Hazard:** Industrial development requires significant impervious surfaces (paving, large roof structures) that dramatically increase surface runoff velocity.
- **Impact:** This accelerated runoff will exacerbate existing bluff formation and slumping along the reservoir banks, threatening the structural integrity of private lands and the reservoir containment itself.
- **Violation of Guidelines:** Provincial Reservoir Lands Guidelines explicitly warn that unauthorized development can destabilize shorelines, requiring expensive geotechnical mitigation that agricultural zoning naturally avoids. [1, 2, 3]

2. Contamination of Vulnerable Hydrological Systems

The waterway connecting Lake McGregor to Travers Reservoir is a primary conveyance for the Bow River Headworks system, supplying irrigation and drinking water. [4]

- **Hazard:** Industrial sites introduce high risks of point-source pollution (chemical spills, cooling fluids) and non-point source pollution (road salts, heavy metals from vehicle traffic).
- **Impact:** Travers Reservoir and McGregor Lake have strictly managed fisheries, including zero-limit closures for walleye and northern pike to protect vulnerable populations. Industrial runoff would degrade the water quality required for these sensitive species and native trout.
- **Downstream Risk:** Pollution entering this corridor travels directly downstream to the Little Bow Reservoir, compounding cumulative effects on water users and the aquatic ecosystem. [2, 5, 6]

3. Disruption of Internationally Recognized Bird Habitat

This corridor overlaps with the **McGregor Lake and Travers Reservoir Important Bird Area (IBA AB016)**.

- **Hazard:** Industrial operations introduce noise pollution, 24-hour lighting, and vertical infrastructure (towers, stacks).
- **Impact:** This area supports over 1,050 American White Pelicans (approx. 1% of the Canadian population) and numerous colonial waterbirds. Industrial disturbance directly conflicts with the nesting and foraging requirements of these species, which agricultural land use historically accommodates.
- **Connectivity:** The corridor serves as a critical functional link for wildlife moving between the reservoirs; industrial fencing and infrastructure would sever this biological connectivity. [7, 8]

4. Incompatibility with Recreational and Resort Land Use

The Little Bow Resort and surrounding "Reservoir Vicinity" lands are designated to prioritize recreation, water storage, and low-impact agriculture. [9]

- **Hazard:** Industrial rezoning (e.g., for data processing or manufacturing) fundamentally alters the land use character, introducing heavy traffic and industrial byproducts.
- **Impact:** This creates an immediate land-use conflict with the recreational value of the Little Bow Resort. The loss of the agricultural buffer zone exposes residents and visitors to "guck," noise, and visual degradation, potentially destroying the local tourism economy. [10, 11]

Conclusion

Changing the land designation from agriculture to industrial in this corridor ignores the physical constraints of the landscape and the documented vulnerability of the watershed. We urge the Council to maintain the current agricultural designation to preserve the stability of the reservoir banks, the integrity of the water supply, and the internationally significant wildlife habitat. Sincerely,

Clint Walls

[1] <https://www.alberta.ca>

[2] <https://open.alberta.ca>

[3] <https://open.alberta.ca>

[4] <https://iaac-aeic.gc.ca>

[5] <https://chatnewstoday.ca>

[6] <https://www.alberta.ca>

[7] <https://parks.canada.ca>

[8] <https://www.ibacanada.org>

[9] <https://orrscgis.com>

[10] <https://open.alberta.ca>

[11] <https://cmscontent.nrs.gov.bc.ca>

From: [Cindy Thomas](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Cc: richardthomaschef@gmail.com; [Cindy Thomas](#)
Subject: Rezoning Application- Bylaw 2026-007 and LBR
Date: June 2, 2026 10:31:28 AM
Attachments: [image001.png](#)
[image002.png](#)
[image003.png](#)

Vulcan County Council
ea@vulcancounty.ab.ca
devassist@vulcancounty.ab.ca

Good morning,

We just wanted to send an email stating our opposition to the Re-zoning and the Proposed Data Processing Project, in the Vulcan County, near the Little Bow Resort. As we understand it, this project has been turned away from a rural area further north of Calgary. This project will impact us in so many ways, including, but not limited to; environmental, fire risks, higher traffic concerns, including access and evacuation, and water consumption. There will be constant industrial noise, light and visual pollution, and could permanently change the footprint of our resort, and thereby causing decreased property values at our resort. Please pass on our disenchantment of this project and rezoning. We will be attending next weeks meeting.

Thank you, please acknowledge receiving our email.

We can be reached through my personal email: ct. [REDACTED],
[REDACTED].
Richard and Cynthia Thomas
[REDACTED] Sunset
Little Bow Resort

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

[REDACTED] [REDACTED]
[REDACTED] [REDACTED]

 
[REDACTED]

From: [Derek Evernden](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026-007 Public Hearing
Date: June 2, 2026 9:42:16 AM
Attachments: [Bylaw 2026-007 Public Hearing - Evernden.pdf](#)

[REDACTED] [ant](#)

Hello,

I'm writing to share the attached letter opposing the proposed Bylaw 2026-007.

My information and reason for writing is included in the attached PDF. If you require a different format, please let me know.

Thank you,
Derek

--

Derek Evernden

He / Him

[REDACTED]

To the Council of Vulcan County,

My name is Derek Evernden and I'm writing to express my opposition to the proposed Bylaw 2026-007. I live in the Village of Milo which draws its water from Lake McGregor. While I do not live as close to the proposed data center as most of those who would be affected by its construction, our water is all connected, and I believe that this will open the doors to more and more of these short-sighted and environmentally disastrous initiatives.

The reason for this land-use change is ultimately for the creation of an 865-acre data center, as the landowner Eric Steeves indicated at the April 1 public hearing.

I want to begin by saying that I'm a fan of solar energy and think that Alberta should embrace it and encourage its implementation. However, as someone who closely follows developments in AI, I believe no public good will come from the proposed land use change and consequent creation of the massive Palliser Grid data center. I believe all evidence suggests it will cause irrevocable damage to the surrounding communities and environment.

My reasons for opposing this project are probably familiar to anyone close to the subject:

1) Data centers threaten local water supplies, cause light, air, noise, and water pollution, destroy the aesthetic beauty of the countryside, and waste agricultural land at a time of global food insecurity.

At a time when water shortages have been a real concern in Alberta, the idea of putting in a water-hungry data center defies logic.

Residents of [Rocky View](#) and [Olds](#) have already put their feet down in opposition to similar proposals in their area, and for good reason.

This nightmare article from the New York Times should be all any resident near a proposed data center needs to convince them that this is resoundingly bad: ["Their Water Taps Ran Dry When Meta Built Next Door"](#)

If the Times article above isn't enough, [this article](#) offers a tidy summary of the areas of concern residents of Rocky View County, [Olds](#) and [Regina](#), namely:

- Power and grid strain.
- Agricultural land and rural character.
- Noise, emissions, and quality of life.

[Data centers rely on back-up generators using natural gas or diesel](#), bringing with them air pollution and greenhouse gas emissions linked to serious health risks. What guarantees do

residents have that the Palliser Grid data center will not rely on the use of these energy back-ups?

Eric Steeves is on the record as showing no concern for the damage this data center will do to the beauty of our land and its enjoyment by residents and visitors, arguing that "[peace and quiet for us farmers in our community doesn't pay the bills](#)"

OK. Let's talk about those bills:

2) Data centers increase energy costs for local residents.

Setting aside the selfish and heart-breaking devaluation of our beautiful land shown in the above quote, data centers bring with them the real possibility of disrupting our energy supplies and [raising electricity rates](#).

[This article](#) outlines how data centers may propose to ultimately "bring their own power" but in the short term most will have to draw from the grid, and there is limited capacity.

"A failure to manage a surge in demand would have catastrophic results [...] If we don't get the balance right [...] electricity in the next 10 years will be impossible for most people to afford without subsidies."

So: pave paradise, put up a data center, pollute the air, and increase the cost of living. Where is the upside?

3) Data centers support an industry that is widely considered unethical, unregulated, and reckless.

The CEO of ChatGPT, Sam Altman, has been lobbying for [complete legal protection from liability if their technology ever causes mass human deaths](#).

The creators of the leading AI companies, including Elon Musk, have been calling for the implementation for some form of [Universal Basic Income because they are certain their technologies will cause massive job loss](#).

[The Travers Solar farm's biggest client is Amazon](#).

It recently came to light that [the U.S. government relies extensively on Amazon Web Services \(AWS\) data centers](#) to process, store, and train artificial intelligence workloads, and is aggressively expanding this partnership.

It is not a stretch to assume the proposed data center may also include AWS as a central client. The security and ethical implications make one's head spin. It doesn't require much imagination to see how an AWS-focussed data center could be a target for sabotage or a terrorist attack. [They were easy recent targets in the UAE.](#)

I admit this is a far more speculative concern than the proven threats outlined in points 1 and 2 above, but I felt it worth considering.

However, "speculation" is an important key word in all of this because:

4) Data centers are investments on a technological future not even its creators can predict.

Huge data centers have been in vogue because companies like Open AI have required massive compute for their sprawling all-purpose AI platforms. But there is already evidence that [AI is shifting to smaller, localized data centers](#) instead.

How long until the gold-rush of giant data centers peters out?

Is this the time to be rolling the dice on such an unproven investment?

What happens to that land if the demand for these huge data centers suddenly drops?

I follow AI news regularly and I've yet to hear of any example of a data centre benefiting anyone but the giant tech companies that want them and the landowners willing to put their financial gain before the well-being of the residents unlucky enough to live nearby.

Thank you for your consideration,

-Derek Evernden

From: [James Ramsden](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: AI Data Centre Development
Date: June 2, 2026 10:52:59 AM

I am writing to formally object to the proposed AI Data Centre development and any associated rezoning or development approvals required for this project within Vulcan County.

While I recognize the importance of economic development and technological advancement, I have significant concerns regarding the scale and potential impacts of this project on our rural community, environment, and infrastructure.

My concerns include the following:

1. **Water Resources**
The proposed facility may require substantial water resources for cooling and operational purposes. I am concerned about the long-term impacts on local water supplies, particularly during periods of drought or water restrictions that already affect agricultural producers and residents.
2. **Electrical Infrastructure and Energy Consumption**
The project's anticipated energy demands appear to be extremely large. I am concerned about the burden placed on Alberta's electrical infrastructure and the potential costs and consequences associated with expanding transmission and distribution systems to support the development.
3. **Noise and Quality of Life**
Large data centres commonly operate continuously and may utilize cooling systems, generators, and other equipment that generate significant noise. These impacts could negatively affect nearby residents, recreational users, and property owners.
4. **Environmental and Agricultural Impacts**
The proposed development has the potential to alter the rural character of the area and may affect agricultural land, wildlife habitat, and natural ecosystems. I believe a comprehensive environmental review should be completed and made available to the public before any approvals are considered.
5. **Traffic and Public Safety**
Construction and ongoing operations may increase heavy truck traffic on local roads, creating safety concerns and additional maintenance costs for county infrastructure.
6. **Limited Community Benefit**
While the project is promoted as an economic opportunity, I question whether the long-term employment and community benefits justify the scale of the development and its potential impacts on local residents and landowners.

Given these concerns, I respectfully request that Council:

- Reject the proposed rezoning and development approvals; or
- At minimum, defer any decision until comprehensive independent studies regarding water use, environmental impacts, noise, traffic, emergency services, and infrastructure requirements have been completed and made available for public review.

I also request that this letter be entered into the public record for any hearing or council meeting concerning this proposal.

Thank you for considering my comments and for representing the interests of Vulcan County residents.

Sincerely

James Ramsden

Sent from my iPad

From: [Maria Thurston](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Quote Bylaw 2026-007
Date: June 2, 2026 12:08:50 PM

Good afternoon Vulcan County Council.

I'm emailing you today regarding regarding the palacer grid bylaw rezoning proposal. A data center may bring in a few taxes to the county, but the environmental harm an extra cost on the residents that live in Vulcan County is not worth the build of a data center. States across the United States have been putting up laws banning data centers in their counties. Along with cities and towns across the United States. Why you may ask? Because of the water usage that has been done by these big corporations. Towns are left with boil water advisories and low water pressures on top of increased water bills because the companies are not paying for the water usage that they are doing. Along with excess energy that is being sucked out of the grid and rolling blackouts happening across towns and counties in the United States. I have heard videos of data center sounds and they are loud and disruption on the brain because they are giving off low frequency vibrations. Low-frequency sounds can cause cognitive impairment, emotional distress, sleep disturbances, and may negatively impact mental health. That's just the facts that you'll have on humans now. What will be the effects on the animals that live in and around Travers reservoir? Along with the light pollution that will be given off. Our beautiful dark skies will have a glow to the east just like Calgary to the North or to Lethbridge to the South. People come to the county for peace and quiet and to get away from the city lights and noises. I know that Data Center will be far away from the town of Vulcan but will also be surrounded by acreages that will have a negative impact on their land value. Crime will also be increased because of the metals that will be provided at the AI data centers and with the fact that low jobs will actually be provided in the long term. People that would be working out of Data Center are highly educated and will not be living in a town like lowland with low necessities. Also, the jobs that will be created during the construction will be from out of town as the construction company will be under contract and there's not a construction company out of Vulcan County that is fit to build a data center. So the jobs that will be temporarily provided for the 4 years of building this data center will be for individuals outside of the county. Also, data centers only provide a small handful of jobs after the build is complete since they can be self-sufficient and operated since it is a computer.

The environmental impacts that will happen because of a data center being built in a high drought zone with farmers that rely on irrigation or no irrigation at all and individuals that rely on Travers for water. Towns across the United States have been dealing with low pressure water and along with boil water advisories because their water is highly contaminated. What will happen if there's a mass of fire and the county needs water to fight it, but the Data Center needs it instead. What happens when there's a massive drought for years and years on end like we've been seeing and what will happen to the farmers and the individuals that live in this area. Along with a fact that this data center will have access to the little bow . What will happen to the communities that rely on the Little bow River to supply them with water. The environmental impact alone is not worth it. A data center warms up the area by 5 to 10°. C. What will happen to the water temperatures in the Traverse reservoir? What will happen to the burrs that live in that area? Data centers haven't been around long enough to know the environmental impacts that they will have around the area that they're built in.

I understand that the Data Center will bring in massive tax revenue, but Volk County alone pays one of the highest taxes in all of Alberta. Will our taxes go down because a data center is built? Will the data center pay for the golf course that the citizens of Vulcan County are paying for themselves? Will the cost of living in Vulcan County be decreased by a massive Data center being built? If the answer is no then a data center shouldn't be built.

AI is being pushed on to the people by massive tech companies and the government without any consultation. Companies are supposed to be working for the citizens and the government is supposed to be working for the citizens. The citizens make the government and vote in the government. Citizens give money to the corporations and allow the corporations to exist by giving them their hard-earned money. AI is actually having a negative effect on the brains and development of young children and also the IQ of individuals. We do not need our data to be stored and to be used against us. We the people do not need to be highly surveilled and controlled and feed information from the government and from massive oligarchs to inform us what we should and should not believe. We, the People have stood up and have voiced our concerns and say that we do not want these data centers. The people are the reason why the Government exists and why oligarchs have so much money. It has been expressed time and time again from old to Red deer to across Alberta and into the United States and then also the anti-ai rally that just happened in Vancouver. The people do not want these data centers. We are in an economic downfall and an environmental catastrophe. We are also in a mass extinction. With water temperatures increasing and the climate increasing. We need to be able to find ways to help the animals that we share this planet with. Not destroy it and take away their homes.

Eric Stevens says that the Data Center will be allowed and open to Farmers in the area to make money. But what about the small working class individuals that actually make this County run? What about the healthcare workers that take care of the seniors and the hospital to extend the care to Peter Dawson Lodge? What about the mom and pop restaurant that is struggling to provide healthy, affordable food to the communities? We do not need rich people getting richer while people that actually live here are struggling. It will not bring investment to this County and it will not create jobs.

Will Vulcan County Council actually listen to the people that live in this County and not one Rich individual that owns a bunch of land and just wants to get wealthier. Will Vulcan County Council listen to the people of Vulcan County that want protect the environment that we live in and the water that we drink. We do not want to be on water restrictions in the near future. We are already on consistent fire restrictions because of the droughts that we constantly deal with. The rain that we have just gotten only happens basically almost every decade. It's not consistent and it is never enough to actually take us out of a drought long-term. Does the Vulcan County cancel actually have a solution to when we went out of water? If the answer is no, then the data center should not be built.

Thank you for your time and I hope you actually sit down and consider the impacts that it will have on this County and this Province and in Canada in turn.

Thank you, Maria Thurston

From: [Renate Grob](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Change of rezoning to industrial
Date: June 2, 2026 3:39:31 PM

To whom it may concern

The application to change the zoning from farmland to industrial should not be granted for following reasons

The location of the land is to close to little bow lake , our waters need protection from industrial waste and drainage of the water level

Wildlife and birds need our protection, so does farmland, future generations need the land to grow there food just as we do.

Value of surrounding properties will decrease, nobody wants to life close to industrial places, as usually water quality and air quality suffer

I would like to ask the council to just imagine that a factory or data center could be there next door neighbor, what a horrifying thought, so I kindly ask the council to protect our farmland, our water, our air, our wild life and our neighbors

With great appreciation for your time and consideration

Sincerely

Renate Grob

[Yahoo Mail: Search, Organize, Conquer](#)

From: [Ron Girvitz](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: "Bylaw 2026-007 Public Hearing"
Date: June 2, 2026 1:20:45 PM
Attachments: [Zoning Submission. June 3.26.final.pdf](#)

Ms. Matlock

Please find attached my written submission in respect of the above captioned matter.

Please add to the public hearing agenda package.

Regards,

Ron

Ronald S. Girvitz, P.Eng., J.D.

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED] Avenue, SW [REDACTED]
Calgary, Alberta T2R 0C6
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

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**IN RESPECT OF AN APPLICATION FOR
A LAND USE BY-LAW AMENDMENT
BY PALLISER GRID, AS APPLICANT, TO VULCAN COUNTY
FOR A PROPOSED BYLAW AMENDMENT OF CERTAIN LANDS
TO REDESIGNATE THE LAND USE DESIGNATION
FROM RURAL GENERAL TO RURAL INDUSTRIAL
PROPOSED BYLAW NO. 2026-007
LAND DESCRIPTION: E/2 OF 15-15-21W4 AND SECTION 14-15-21 W4
CONTAINING APPROXIMATELY 850 ACRES MORE OR LESS
(the “APPLICATION”)**

HEARING DATE: JUNE 10, 2026

**BRIEF OF ARGUMENT
OF RONALD S. GIRVITZ**

**ON BEHALF OF
LITTLE BOW RESORT AI DATA CENTRE COMMITTEE**

DATED: JUNE 3, 2026

PART I. INTRODUCTION AND LBR COMMITTEE’S CONCERNS

1. The Little Bow Resort AI Data Centre Committee (the “**LBR Committee**”) is a group of landowners who own property at the Little Bow Resort located in Vulcan County. The LBR Committee has been authorized by a majority of landowners owning property at the Little Bow Resort to represent their collective interests. It should not be construed or interpreted that any representation or submissions by the LBR Committee supersedes or replaces any representation or submission from any self represented landowner owning property at the Little Bow Resort or elsewhere.
2. This submission is provided pursuant to the Notice of Public Hearing issued by Vulcan County in respect of the Application advising of a public hearing to be held on June 10, 2026 in the Champion Community Hall, Champion, Alberta (the “**Notice of Public Hearing**”). The Notice of Public Hearing advises that written submissions are to be submitted not later than 12:00 noon, June 3, 2026.
3. We request that this submission be added to the record for the subject Application.
4. The purpose of this submission is to generally outline aspects which, if not addressed and properly considered by the Vulcan County Council (the “**Council**”) in the upcoming decision whether to accept the Application for a zoning change, could lead to a declaration of invalidity by the Court of King’s Bench of Alberta pursuant to a judicial review application.
5. A judicial review application is outlined in Sections 536 and 537 of the *Municipal Government Act* (the “**Act**”). It is an expensive and time consuming process for all parties and the LBR Committee strongly urges Council to take steps to avoid giving cause to commence this review process.
6. It is submitted that a thorough and comprehensive review of the substantive requirements of the subject Application is in the best interests of all parties and will ensure an outcome that meets the listed requirements as set out by the Council in its own bylaws and policies.
7. As at the time of this submission, a request for disclosure pursuant to the (Alberta) *Access to Information Act* was filed by the writer to Vulcan County and its employees relating to the Application. The required disclosure has not yet been provided by the recipient. We reserve the right to provide further submissions based on the content of the disclosure received notwithstanding the Council imposed submission deadline of June 3, 2026.

8. The procedural history of this Application is as follows:
- (a) The Application is dated January 9, 2026 and appears to have been updated on January 21, 2026;
 - (b) First reading of the associated bylaw was approved by Council on March 11, 2026;
 - (c) Following first reading of the associated bylaw, Council provided a form of notice advising of a hearing to be held on April 1, 2026 (the “**First Public Hearing**”);
 - (d) During the April 1, 2026 public hearing, the Applicant provided both written and oral submissions in support of the Application (the “**Original Applicant Submissions**”);
 - (e) During and shortly following the April 1, 2026 public hearing, a significant number of written and oral submission were provided by affected and interested persons addressing a wide variety of issues, substantially in opposition to the Application (the “**Original Affected Person Submissions**”);
 - (f) The Notice of Public Hearing advised that a new public hearing would be convened to consider the Application. The Notice of Public Hearing also advised that the Original Applicant Submissions and the Original Affected Person Submissions would not be considered as part of the June 10, 2026 public hearing. As a result, the Applicant and all affected persons are required to provide new written or oral submissions if such parties wish to have their submissions considered by Council.
 - (g) The Notice of Public Hearing contained a link to the copy of By-Law 2026-007 and the Application.
9. The issues that will be outlined in this submission are some, but likely not all of the requirements that must be incorporated or satisfied by the Application and Council to avoid a finding of invalidity by the Court of King’s Bench pursuant to a judicial review application. They are summarized as follows and will be described in greater detail in the body of this submission:
- (a) Procedural Fairness – it is the responsibility of Council to ensure that the process is procedurally fair to all participants. Some aspects of this requirement appear to have emerged and are summarized as follows:
 - (i) During the First Public Hearing on April 1, 2026, the Application was amended which was both a material change to the proposed project and an amendment to the statutory application requirements. If during the June 10, 2026 public hearing, the Applicant again provides any

written or oral submissions which amend the original Application, the June 10, 2026 hearing should be suspended and a new process should be restarted with a new amended bylaw, first reading, notice provided to all interested or affected parties and a new public hearing; and

- (ii) The requirement to give reasons. Given the importance and effect of the Application, Council must give reasons for any decision rendered as part of this Application including the decision to change the zoning of the subject land. Failure to provide reasons for its decision, would constitute a reviewable error and risk a declaration of invalidity by a court.
- (b) Substantive Requirements Not Met - There are a number of substantive requirements set out by Council which are deficient and not satisfied by the Application. They are summarized as follows:
- (i) the purpose set out in the Rural Industrial – R1 zoning description is not satisfied;
 - (ii) the Application does not meet the requirements of a Data Processing Operation;
 - (iii) requirements of Section 62.1 of the Land Use Bylaw are not satisfied;
 - (iv) the Industrial Siting Standards set out in Section 13.1 of Schedule 2 – R1 attached to the Land Use Bylaw were not satisfied because: (a) the Application did not include the water intake aspect of the proposed project; and (b) both the water intake aspect of the proposed project and the remaining aspects of the proposed project are not sufficiently set back from the listed items.
10. For all of the above reasons, the LBR Committee submits that the Application is deficient and strongly urges the Council to deny the Application. Failing to address these described deficiencies will open the decision to a review by the Court of King's Bench and potentially lead to a decision to render the resulting bylaw invalid.
11. The LBR Committee is not opposed to an AI data processing centre located in Vulcan County but urges Council to carefully consider the best placement for such a significant industrial development. The best placement should not be dictated by landowner applicants but should instead be proactively determined by Council and its staff by considering all of the relevant and material factors and then determining the best location for an industrial zoning area.

PART II. GENERAL PRINCIPLES

12. It is submitted that there are a few basic principles in any administrative hearing that should always be considered. While these basic principles may appear obvious, it is worth mentioning to ensure that no substantial mistakes are made with respect to the decision making concerning the Application.
13. The first basis principal is the requirement for the decision maker to consider the whole of the record. The Application and all verbal and written submission made as part of the public hearing process are all part of the record and must be considered.
14. In the present case, the record includes, as part of the Application, a request to rezone the subject lands to “enable the development of a Data Processing Operation and supporting infrastructure”. The Application does not propose a land use change to an industrial classification for a general or a “to be determined” purpose. Instead, the Application specifically seeks rezoning for a specific purpose.
15. It is therefore submitted that all substantive requirements required to grant the Application must consider the purpose of the Application described above since it was specifically included in the Application. All substantive requirements must be considered whether a Data Processing Operation meets the siting, environmental, nuisance and any general application requirements in order to be approved.
16. Secondly, again while obvious, it must be emphasized that it is solely the responsibility of the Applicant to tender sufficient evidence to meet all substantive zoning requirements of a Data Processing Operation. Any missing or insufficient evidence for any requirement must cause the Application to be denied. It is not the responsibility for any party, other than the Applicant to ensure that all such requirements are satisfied.
17. This submission will review the various zoning requirement to change the zoning of the subject lands to a Rural Industrial – RI classification and any missing or insufficient evidence is the responsibility of the Applicant, not the intervenors or Council.
18. It is submitted that upon a finding that any required evidence to meet all substantive requirements is missing or insufficient should cause the Application to be denied.

PART III. THE REQUIREMENTS OF PROCEDURAL FAIRNESS

19. In a proceeding of this nature, there is an obligation incumbent upon Council to ensure that the process utilized is procedurally fair. Failing to meet this procedural fairness requirement will be judicially reviewable and cause the applicable decision to be declared invalid. There are many requirements of procedural fairness and this Part shall describe some of these requirements that have appeared to have emerged throughout the conduct of the process.

(A) THE APPLICATION WAS AMENDED DURING THE FIRST PUBLIC HEARING

20. In the original Application dated January 9, 2026 and amended January 22, 2026, the Applicant specified electrical servicing by way of a new on site high voltage substation. The implication is that electrical servicing was to be provided by way of a tie in to the existing electricity power grid to supply the majority of its electrical requirements.
21. During the First Public Hearing, the Original Applicant Submissions provided a material change to the electrical servicing. The Original Applicant Submissions changed the electrical servicing to the lands from the existing grid to “its own generation capacity”. In essence, the Applicant changed its application from sourcing the majority of its electricity from the existing power grid to electricity production on site.
22. The LBR Committee understands that the Original Applicant Submission will not be considered as part of the June 10, 2026. However, if the Applicant provides new submissions that change the electrical servicing to the subject lands in similar fashion as the Original Applicant Submissions, then it is submitted that such change should be deemed to be an amendment to the Application for which proper notice is required to all affected persons pursuant to MGA and the Council’s own notice bylaws.
23. This anticipated change of the source of electricity is highly problematic for two major reasons.
24. Firstly, the anticipated change would be a material change to the Application and would be made without notice to any affected landowner or person. The magnitude of the electrical generation facilities is enormous and will be substantially larger and be required to produce more power than any other current electrical generation facility in Alberta at full buildout at 2GW.
25. No person attending the hearing would have had any form of notice that a major power plant was now proposed by the Applicant. Without adequate or reasonable notice, the process would be made procedurally unfair.

26. Secondly, Section 62.1(b)(vi) of the Vulcan County's Land Use Bylaw specifies that as part of a zoning redesignation application, the applicant must specify the location of the facilities and services (such as electricity) to service the subject property.
27. By changing the electricity sources from utilizing existing infrastructure to on site electricity generation, the Applicant will have done more than propose a material change to the Application. The Applicant would have amended the Application by changing the description of the requirements set out in Section 62.1(b)(vi) of the Land Use Bylaw.
28. It is submitted that if the Applicant amends the Application as outlined above, then the entire rezoning application process would have to be restarted with a new proposed bylaw, new first reading, new notice to all affected landowners and persons and a new scheduled public hearing to consider the amended Application.
29. It is submitted that amending the Application as described above and proceeding to conduct a public hearing without reasonable notice of the amendment would cause the public hearing and the process to become procedurally unfair and would be a breach of Vulcan County's own requirements to amend its bylaws.

(B) COUNCIL MUST PROVIDE REASONS FOR ITS DECISION

30. One of the requirements for procedural fairness in decision making processes is for Council to fulfill its obligations to provide reasons for its decision, particularly where the decision affects a persons' rights, privileges and interests.
31. The LBR Committee does appreciate that currently, no decision has been rendered with respect to the Application, but it does expect that when a decision is made, that adequate reasons are provided by Council to ensure that it has fully considered the Application, its obligation to ensure that the process was procedurally fair and that all substantive requirements were met.
32. It is submitted that given the substantial effect upon the Applicant and the property owners affected by the Application, it is incumbent upon the Council to provide meaningful and substantial reasons in support of its decision and to explain why it has rejected either the Application or submissions made in opposition to the Application.

33. It is submitted that approving bylaw 2026-007 without detailed and substantial reasons would be procedurally unfair. Conversely, it would be procedurally unfair to deny bylaw 2026-007 without suitable reasons.

PART IV. SUBSTANTIVE COMPLIANCE

34. The Vulcan County Land Use Bylaw 2020-028 (consolidated to Bylaw 2025-027) (the “**Land Use Bylaw**”) outlines a number of requirements that must be satisfied as part of the Application.
35. It is incumbent upon the Applicant to provide sufficient evidence to allow Council to determine whether each and every such requirement is satisfied. If any requirement is not met, then it is submitted that the Application should be denied.
36. Aside from the one page form of application, the Application is set out in two following pages entitled “Applicant Submission: Rezoning from Rural General to General Industrial” (the “**Applicant Submission**”). It is presumed that the intent of the Applicant Submission is to address the substantive compliance for such application as outlined in the Land Use Bylaw.
37. The remaining approximately 39 pages attached are entitled “AI Data Centre Campus Master Plan” which do not seem to attempt to address any of the substantive requirements of the Land Use Bylaw and appear to be related to the management of the proposed AI data centre project.
38. It is noted that the title of the Applicant Submission indicates that the document seeks to meet the rezoning requirements from Rural General to General Industrial. With respect, there is no designation found in the Land Use Bylaw described as “General Industrial”.
39. Further, under the heading “Proposed designation and use of the property” the Applicant again references a zoning classification of “General Industrial”.
40. It submitted that the Applicant Submission indicating the desired zoning change to “General Industrial” is not merely a typographical error but is instead is a substantive error in the Application.
41. With respect, a zoning change application should clearly specify the desired zoning classification and this lack of attention to detail is problematic especially when significant effects upon the environment and adjacent landowners can reasonably be expected.

(A)RURAL INDUSTRIAL - RI PURPOSE

42. The Land Use Bylaw specified the purpose for Rural Industrial – RI zoning as follows:
- PURPOSE: To allow industrial uses to be located in rural areas provided they do not pose a threat to the environment or create a potential nuisance for residents.**
43. It is submitted that the Application must satisfy the “purpose” described above.
44. There are two requirements that must be considered and satisfied: (a) the use does not pose a threat to the environment; and (b) the use does not create a potential nuisance for residents.
45. A review of the Application indicates that there is no evidence contained that the proposed use does not pose a threat to the environment. It is silent in this regard.
46. It is expected that a significant number of submissions provided by interested persons at the Public Hearing will indicate that the Application does pose a threat to the environment.
47. The second aspect of the “purpose” is that the use does not cause a nuisance to the residents in the area.
48. A “nuisance” is generally defined as:
- an unlawful interference with a person’s use or enjoyment of their land (private) or with public rights (public). It involves unreasonable, substantial, and often continuous interference such as excessive noise, odor, or pollutants that disrupts comfort or safety.**
49. It is expected that a significant number of submissions provided by interested persons at the Public Hearing will argue that the Application will cause a nuisance in the form of light, noise, smell, pollution, traffic congestion, egress in an emergent situation and other interferences with their use and enjoyment of their property.
50. A review of the Application indicates that there is no evidence contained that the proposed use does not cause a nuisance to residents in the area. Again, it is silent in this regard.
51. For these reasons, it is submitted that the Application is deficient with respect to the requirements to satisfy the purpose of the Rural Industrial – RI zoning and should be denied.

(B) THE PROPOSED PROJECT IS NOT A DATA PROCESSING OPERATION

52. One of the discretionary uses in the Rural Industrial – RI description is a “Data Processing Operation” as described in Section 1.2. The Application specifically indicates that its intention is to construct a Data Processing Operation.

53. A Data Processing Operation is defined in Bylaw 2020-028 (as amended by 2022-021) as follows:

DATA PROCESSING OPERATION means a heavily industrial facility consisting of a building or a group of buildings housing powerful highly specialized computers that are used to verify digital transactions and require 24/7 climate control. This use may include an onsite power plant. Data processing includes data storage, crypto mining, and other similar uses. (underline is my own)

54. It is submitted that the Application does not propose to construct a Data Processing Operation. Instead, the Application proposes to construct an AI data centre campus which is materially different than a Data Processing Operation as it is defined.

55. The definition of a Data Processing Operation outlined above, specifies that the use of the facility is to “verify digital transactions”. It is submitted that the drafters of Bylaw 2020-028 (as amended by 2022-021) chose to specifically limit the use of a Data Processing Operation by inserting a specific use or application of the housed computers. The definition is not broad and is specific to its listed use.

56. It is submitted that the use outlined in the Application is materially distinct from the use specified in the definition of a Data Processing Operation for the following reasons:

- (a) an AI data centre campus is constructed to run and operate an AI computing, storage and networking function;
- (b) a facility used to verify digital transactions requires a separate application system which may include identity verification, fraud detection, risk scoring and compliance tools; and
- (c) a facility used to verify digital transactions is a specific application of an AI data centre campus and is distinct therefrom. An AI data centre is able to host a facility to verify digital transactions but is not in of itself, a facility used to verify digital transactions.

57. The Application does not indicate that the proposed facility would be used to verify digital transactions. Instead, the Application indicates that the proposed facility would be used for general AI computing purposes.
58. It is conceded that if Bylaw 2020-028 (as amended by 2022-021) were amended to remove the specific use to verify digital transactions and instead specify general AI computing purposes, that the Application would meet that amended definition of a Data Processing Operation. However, it is submitted that until the definition of a Data Processing Operation is amended, the Application does not meet the definition of such a facility.

(C) REQUIREMENTS OF SECTION 62.1 OF LAND USE BYLAW NOT SATISFIED

59. Section 62.1 of the Land Use Bylaw specifies that:

A request for redesignation from one land use district to another shall be accompanied by the following information: (underline is my own)

- (a) a completed application form and fee;
- (b) a narrative describing the:
 - (i) proposed designation and future use(s);
 - (ii) consistency with the Municipal Development Plan and applicable statutory plans;
 - (iii) consistency with the *South Saskatchewan Regional Plan* and any applicable provincial legislation or policies (i.e. *Water Act*, *Wetland Policy*, etc.);
 - (iv) compatibility of the proposal with surrounding uses and zoning;
 - (v) the suitability of the site, including identification of any constraints and/or hazard areas, (i.e. easements, soil conditions, topography, drainage, etc.);
 - (vi) availability of facilities and services (sewage disposal, domestic water, gas, electricity, fire and police protection, schools, etc.) to serve the subject property; and
 - (vii) access considerations including potential impacts on public roads;
- (c) a diagram containing the following information prepared by a professional:
 - (i) the dimensioned development potential of the site, including proposed location of structures, access point, and any constraints and/or hazard areas (i.e. easements, soil conditions, topography, drainage, etc.) and a conceptual subdivision design;
 - (ii) proposed location of facilities and services (sewage disposal, domestic water, gas, electricity) to serve the subject property dimensioned to property lines and structures;
- (d) a report prepared by a certified Private Sewage Disposal System (PSDS) installer or another qualified consultant that includes:
 - (i) a drawing that shows:
 - locations of springs, dugouts or well accessing ground water
 - location of proposed system
 - locations of test pit or bore hole
 - location and size of the PSDS reserve system (if any);
 - (ii) documentation identifying soil characteristics and results of laboratory soil texture classification;

- (iii) comments on the ability of a proposed system to be sited on the property and maintain required clearance distances;
- (e) an evaluation of surface drainage which may include adjacent properties; and
- (f) any other information deemed necessary by Council to properly evaluate the application and to understand the impacts and/or merits of the application.

60. Section 62.1 sets out mandatory requirements that the Application must include in order to be complete and considered by Vulcan County.
61. Section 62.1 contains the word “shall” which clearly indicates the mandatory nature of all elements listed. It is submitted that any missing items listing in Section 62.1 causes the Application to become deficient and must be denied.
62. It is submitted that the two page Applicant Submission is substantially deficient with respect to these mandatory requirements because:
 - (a) there is no information with respect to consistency with the Master Development plan as required by subsection b(ii);
 - (b) there is no information with respect to consistency with the South Saskatchewan Regional Plan or other applicable provincial legislation or policies as required by subsection b(iii);
 - (c) there is minimal information other than three bullet points to address the requirement of information for compatibility with surrounding uses and zoning as required by subsection b(iv);
 - (d) there is only very basic information relating to information for site suitability (land base, electrical transmission, water resources, and rural context) and there is no description of any constraints and or hazard areas (other than mere mention of floodplain, wildlife risk and low seismic risk) as required by subsection b(v);
 - (e) as previously described, the availability of facilities required by subsection b(vi) is an area of concern because of the Applicant’s change to the Applicant’s Original Submission by amending the electrical facilities from a tie in to the existing grid to electrical self generation. In addition, the water servicing is problematic because (as will be detailed further in this submission) the facilities to provide water servicing must be included in the siting determination pursuant to Section 13.1 of the RI description;
 - (f) there is no information relating to fire and police protection as required by subsection b(vi);
 - (g) there is no information submitted by a “professional” with subject matter expertise relating to the items described in section (c) nor has the

Applicant submitted any evidence to suggest that anyone producing the Applicant holds a relevant professional designation;

- (h) there is no information submitted by a certified Private Sewage Disposal System (PSDS) installer or another qualified consultant to address the items listed in section (d) nor has the Applicant submitted any evidence the anyone producing the Application holds such certification or qualification; and
 - (i) there is no information relating to an evaluation of surface draining other than a mere mention that stormwater will be managed on site as required by section (e); and
 - (j) the Application indicates that surface drainage evaluations will be completed at development or permit stage which is a direct breach of the requirements set out in section (e).
63. With all due respect to the Applicant, an application to amend zoning to a Rural Industrial with an anticipated AI data complex with a tie in to the existing grid (or its own power generation facilities, in whichever direction the Applicant proceeds) deserves much more rigour and detail than the Application sets out.
64. It is submitted that the Applicant is almost entirely incomplete with respect to the mandatory requirements for such an application as set out in Section 62.1 of the Land Use Bylaw.
65. It is submitted that it is the responsibility of Vulcan County to review the requirements of Section 62.1 and ensure that all requirements are included in the Application and if any item is missing, then the Application should be returned to the Applicant as incomplete.

**(D) SITING REQUIREMENTS - MUST CONSIDER WHOLE PROJECT
PROPOSED – SITING REQUIREMENTS NOT MET**

66. Section 13.1 of the Rural Industrial – RI description attached as Schedule 2 – RI to the Land Use Bylaw sets out the required siting standards. A set back of 1.6 km is required from a set of listed items.
67. It is expected that submissions from other interested parties will measure the distance from the land boundary lines to the listed items and argue that the distance set back does not meet the required set back of 1.6 km.
68. In addition, there is a glaring omission in the Application with respect to the requirements of Section 13.1. It is not contentious that the proposed AI data centre campus facility will require make up water drawn from Travers

reservoir. With respect, it is submitted that the proposed facility will require water intake pipes located in Travers reservoir and intake water pumps, likely located at or near the water intake pipes.

69. It is submitted that it is required that Vulcan County consider the whole of the proposed facility and not isolate or ignore any part. The water intake system is integral to the proposed use outlined in the Application and must be considered along with all aspects of the proposed facility. Therefore, the siting requirements outlined in Section 13.1 must include consideration of the water intake system.
70. It is submitted that once the water intake system is considered, the siting requirements outlined in Section 13.1 are clearly not satisfied.

PART V. RELIEF REQUESTED

71. For all these reasons it is the LBR Committee's position that:
 - (a) many substantive requirements that the Application must satisfy are either deficient or missing;
 - (b) Vulcan County should deny the Application based on these deficient or missing requirements; and
 - (c) should Vulcan County choose to grant the Application in its present form, a judicial review application will be sought to declare the resulting bylaw invalid based on these deficient or missing substantive requirements.
72. It is the LBR Committee's strong preference that the process used to consider the Application is fair to all affected parties, that the Application address and satisfy all substantive requirements and that all parties avoid an expensive and time consuming judicial review application process.
73. As stated, the LBR Committee is not opposed to a data processing centre located in Vulcan County but urges Council to carefully consider the best placement for such a significant industrial development. The best placement should not be dictated by landowner applicants but should instead be proactively determined by Council and its staff by considering all of the relevant and material factors and then determining the best location for an industrial zoning area. Those parties who own land within the determination by Council of the best location for an industrial development of this nature could then consider whether to seek the appropriate approvals to construct such a development.

All of which is respectfully submitted this 3rd day of June, 2026.

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to be 'R. Girvitz', with a horizontal line extending to the right.

**RONALD S. GIRVITZ
ON BEHALF OF THE
LITTLE BOW RESORT AI COMMITTEE**

From: [Sandy Whitman](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Objection to Bylaw 2026-007
Date: June 2, 2026 4:17:41 PM

To the County of Vulcan Council,

I am writing to formally request that the public hearing for Bylaw 2026-007 be deemed invalid due to serious concerns about procedural fairness.

First, the hearing did not provide a fair or reasonable opportunity for meaningful public participation. Due to limited space in the Council Chamber, more than forty attendees were placed in an overflow room where the audio was extremely poor and visual access to the presentation was delayed. As a result, many attendees could not properly follow the hearing, and some left before having the opportunity to make verbal submissions.

Second, the County included significant new project information in the online agenda package that was not discussed during the hearing by either the County or the applicant. This information was not provided to attendees in advance, and the public was given no meaningful opportunity to review or comment on these changes.

Thirdly the safety of residents of the Little Bow Resort and the Southern Alberta Bible Camp is major concern in the event of a fire at the proposed facility the residents would have to head towards the fire as we have one road for egress . All sources of approval for this facility will bare responsibility.

Finally, the bylaw does not properly address the land use related to the associated pumping station and pipeline, and the required zoning setbacks were not met, particularly given the proximity to Travers Reservoir and the recreational area.

These issues undermine the integrity of the hearing process and raise serious concerns regarding fairness under the Municipal Government Act.

Sandy and Bill Whitman
 Lakeside Drive
Little Bow Resort

Sent from my iPad

From: [Wendy Noualy](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: bylaw 2026-007
Date: June 2, 2026 3:00:10 PM

[REDACTED]
<https://aka.ms/LearnAboutSenderIdentification>]

June 2, 2026

To Whom It May Concern:

We had prepared a lengthy presentation on the problems that are going to occur if you allow this rezone to happen for the AI data center. You already know of all the problems that north America is having with these projects and what they are doing to the environment.

So, We are not sending you a big file to review. I am sure that you have heard it all.

It will set a precedent for more harmful things to come from it. We strongly appose the rezoning for such projects and any and all others that may be

affiliated now or in the future.

Common sense has to come into play here and the people are shouting it from the rooftops. We sincerely hope that the county pays attention. We can't get our water back if you allow this to take it.

Sincerely,

Wendy and Emmanuel Noualy

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This email has been checked for viruses by Avast antivirus software.
www.avast.com

From: [Leanne Anderson](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: AI Data Centre
Date: June 2, 2026 8:35:17 PM

Dear Alena,

I am writing to formally oppose and request the denial of the proposed AI data centre development in our community.

While technological innovation is important, this project presents significant risks and costs that outweigh its potential benefits to local residents, farmers, and the environment.

One of the most concerning issues is the enormous demand for water required to operate AI data centres. At a time when local farmers face ongoing challenges obtaining irrigation rights and securing sufficient water for agricultural production, it is difficult to justify allocating large volumes of water to support artificial intelligence computing.

Agriculture provides essential food production, supports local livelihoods, and contributes directly to the regional economy. Prioritizing an industrial data centre over the needs of farmers sends the wrong message about our community's values and long-term priorities.

The project would also place substantial demands on the electrical grid. AI data centres are among the most energy-intensive industrial facilities being developed today. Their operation requires vast amounts of power, potentially increasing pressure on existing infrastructure and creating additional environmental impacts. Residents should not bear the burden of higher infrastructure costs or reduced system reliability to support a facility that provides limited direct benefits to the community.

Furthermore, the economic benefits of this proposal appear overstated. While construction may create temporary jobs, AI data centres typically employ relatively few permanent workers once operational. In contrast, the long-term environmental and resource costs remain with the community for decades.

The proposal also raises concerns regarding land use, traffic, noise, environmental sustainability, and the precedent it sets for future industrial development. Before approving such a project, decision-makers must ask whether dedicating valuable land, water, and energy resources to AI computing serves the broader public interest.

Given the significant concerns surrounding water allocation, energy consumption, environmental impacts, and limited long-term economic benefits, I respectfully urge the approving authority to reject this application.

Our community's resources should be directed toward projects that provide clear and lasting benefits to residents, support local agriculture, protect the environment, and promote sustainable economic growth.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Alan & Leanne Kwasnicki

Sent from my iPhone

From: [A W](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: BYLAW 2026-007
Date: June 2, 2026 9:19:24 PM

Good Morning,

This email addresses my objections with Bylaw 2026-007 and the proposed rezoning of ag land to industrial.

1. This proposed rezone ignores the Vulcan County Reservoir Area Structure Plan, Bylaw 2020-15

1-1 PURPOSE

This Reservoir Area Structure Plan (“Reservoir ASP”) provides a comprehensive framework for future development within the plan area ensuring: the efficient use of land, adequate provision of infrastructure and public facilities, **conservation of resources**, economic development opportunities, **protection of significant natural environments, and the development of healthy, safe and viable communities.**

Policies have been developed to achieve the following objectives:

- Facilitation of orderly development,
- **Protection of the irrigation and water supply functions of the reservoirs,**
- **Reduction of land use conflicts,**
- **Collaborative stakeholder input and intermunicipal cooperation,**
- Compatibility with Provincial Policies and Regulations,
- Provision of a safe and efficient road network, and
- **Protection of the natural environment and historical resources.**

2-6 RESERVOIR PROTECTION

Travers and McGregor Reservoirs are **a source of drinking and irrigation water** for developments around the reservoirs and for several towns in the Bow River Irrigation District. They are also major recreational resources for the region.

3-3 GUIDING PRINCIPLES

Agricultural Protection

High quality agricultural lands should be protected while still allowing for subdivision and development to occur. Future development should respect agricultural areas within and adjacent to the plan area by avoiding land use conflicts.

Reservoir Protection

The primary consideration for the reservoirs is their watersupply function. Negative impacts of development should be minimized, particularly in areas directly adjacent to reservoirs.

Environmental strategies shall be prepared prior to development to demonstrate how negative impacts will be mitigated. Public reservoir access should be provided in a manner that is sensitive to the natural environment.

Environmental Stewardship

Environmentally sensitive areas should be protected from negative development impacts. Innovative approaches such as green infrastructure, water conservation and low impact development are encouraged to achieve environmental sustainability. Natural resources should be respected to avoid destruction or overuse.

7-2 INDUSTRY

Agri- business proposals shall be considered on a case by case basis. The size and location of any proposed residential or industrial lots or parcels shall not significantly affect the irrigation infrastructure of the area or any farm irrigation systems. Portions of the ASP area are appropriate for the development of industrial uses including oil and gas and renewable resource sectors. Future development should be supported as long as proposed development does not negatively impact existing development or environmentally sensitive areas.

Policy 7.2.1 Proposed industrial uses will require a Land Use Amendment.

Policy 7.2.2 Redesignation and subdivision for new or expanded industrial uses that preserve the integrity of riparian areas and reservoir water quality may be considered.

Policy 7.2.3 **New industrial development should not negatively impact adjacent development**

2. This proposed rezone is in opposition to the Vulcan County Municipal Development Plan

GENERAL POLICIES:

2.11 Vulcan County encourages diverse new development opportunities throughout the region, **while continuing to support agriculture as the primary land use in the County.**

2.12 Proposals for future development (including statutory plans, land use bylaw amendments, subdivision and development) shall be required to submit all information necessary for the approving authority to make an informed decision, and shall be made in the form and manner specified by the approving authority.

2.13 Land use decisions shall strive to balance the impact of new development on existing land uses.

2.14 The County aims to keep a balanced mix of residential/farmland and non-residential properties to help ensure long-term economic stability. This balance supports the County's ability to provide services without exceeding its financial capacity.

2.15 The municipality should support opportunities to diversify the local economy.

2.16 The municipality's economic development strategies shall focus on: (a) enhancing and developing the strengths of the community; and (b) maintaining, enhancing and marketing local amenities to diversify economic opportunities.

2.17 The following factors shall be considered when locating new development in the County: **(a) the compatibility of the proposed development with existing uses in the surrounding area;** (b) the presence of natural landscape features that may impact or be affected by the proposed development; **(c) the impact on agricultural operations and other adjacent land uses in the area;** and (d) the impact on local roads and the provincial highway network.

2.18 Area-specific/grouped development is preferred as it provides the benefit of compatibility for access, servicing, land use and availability of labour; in turn serving to support hamlets and urban service centres. **The County encourages the development of commercial and industrial uses in the existing areas identified in this Plan** (see Map 2) but, the County is open to all varieties of development in any location demonstrated as suitable.

Summary:

The language of the Area Structure Plan and Municipal Development Plans repeatedly make reference to the guiding principles of agricultural protection, reservoir protection, and environmental stewardship. To rezone 800 acres of agricultural land adjacent to an environmentally significant reservoir is in stark contrast to both of these bylaw documents. Vulcan is home to the largest wind and solar installations in the country, and is fast becoming a dumping ground for industrial projects with much vocal opposition from residents. The proposed rezoning is adjacent to residential areas, and will have a disproportionate negative

effect on these residents their approved existing land uses.

Amanda Weiberg



From: [Armin Grob](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Change of use
Date: June 2, 2026 5:26:55 PM

[REDACTED]

To whom it may concern

I am against this proposal for the following but not limited reasons .

Farmland is feeding us

Onces the land is rezoned the owner can build whatever he wants

We do not need farmland to have industry

If that gets approved more landowners will do the same

Stop this nonsense please

Armin Grob

[REDACTED] Range Road 245 Vulcan Alberta

From: [Bob Pusch](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026-007 Public Hearing.
Date: June 2, 2026 10:14:34 PM
Attachments: [image001.png](#)
[County of Vulcan letter.pdf](#)

[Redacted]

Please see attached my letter regarding this hearing.

Regards,

Bob Pusch

[Redacted]

[Redacted]

[Redacted]

 LAKESIDE DR.
Little Bow Resort, Alberta

June 2, 2026

County of Vulcan Council

Re: Proposed bylaw No.2026-007

Dear Councilors,

I sincerely appreciate the opportunity to express my views on the proposed land use change for section 14 and portions of E ½ 15-15-21-W4 from Rural General to Rural industrial. As an owner of a cabin at Little Bow Resort for over 20 years, and a taxpayer in the County of Vulcan, my wife and I object to this land use change. By changing this land to rural industrial, it is only a matter of time that something industrial will be built there. As an owner of a light industrial plant in the County of Paintearth, I bring some expertise to this subject. My plant was built with keeping the local community & residents in mind, and happy. The closest village is 18 KM away, and the community continues to support my business, as we engage and cooperate with the local residents.

This section of land is only 2 miles from the Little Bow Resort community of over 200 cabins, and it will affect us immensely in a negative way. We hope you will reconsider this land use change, and thank you again for your time

Regards,

Bob Pusch

Bob Pusch



From: [Brian Reiersen](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Cc: [Lansey Middleton](#)
Subject: Rezoning of Rural industrial land
Date: June 2, 2026 9:55:15 PM

I am sending this email to voice my concerns about the rezoning of land to industrial to be used for a data center.

My concerns are centered on the following key issues: Water Security and Scarcity: Southern Alberta faces increasing water stress. Large-scale data centres can consume millions of litres of water daily for cooling—often equivalent to the usage of a small ci. In drought years, this poses a direct threat to our agricultural irrigation and local water licenses.

Strain on the Electrical Grid: AI processing is extremely energy-intensive, often requiring up to 10 times the power of traditional cloud computing. Even if the project proposes "bring your own energy," the construction of new gas-fired power plants nearby introduces noise and air pollution concerns for neighboring families.

Loss of Agricultural Land: Vulcan County's greatest asset is its farmland. Converting prime agricultural land into industrial "concrete paradises" is an irreversible decision that undermines our long-term food security and rural character.

Limited Long-Term Employment: While construction may provide a temporary boost, data centres are notorious for requiring very few permanent, local staff once operational. This project does not provide the sustainable, high-volume employment our community deserves in exchange for such a heavy resource footprint.

Impact on Property Values and Quality of Life: The continuous 24/7 noise from cooling fans and potential light pollution from large industrial complexes will negatively impact the quiet, rural lifestyle that residents have invested in.

I urge the Council to deny the permit for this project. At a minimum, I request that no further approvals be granted until an independent, third-party environmental and social impact assessment is completed and shared transparently with the public.

Thank you for your time and for representing the best interests of Vulcan County.

Brian Reiersen
[REDACTED] Lakeside Drive
Vulcan County
Little Bow Resort

From: [Clayton Stokes](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026-007
Date: June 3, 2026 10:18:35 AM

Clayton Stokes
Sunset Drive Littlebow Resort
Lomond AB, T0L 1G0

2026-06-03

To: Vulcan County Council

Dear members of council

I am writing to express my strong opposition to Land Use Bylaw 2026-007.

I am deeply concerned about the possibility that this bylaw could open the door to development such as AI data center or other large-scale industrial uses near our lake community. This is not an industrial zone, It is a quiet recreational and residential community that has been my permanent residence for over 20 years. Furthermore I find it hard to believe that anyone with a similar place of residency and who understands the value and nature of what living next to a large water body encompasses would sit on the fore side of things.

My concerns are as follows

Things I noticed about our local roadway is it is already very busy with large truck traffic hauling cattle and feed from feedlots to slaughter houses, trailers marked with company names on them. who do not reside in our county and already the road shows signs of wear. I live here for the peaceful setting and am accustomed to quiet roads, and an industrial development would definitely increase traffic and create a nuisance. Industrial development would threaten the nostalgia and tranquility of our Community. The county has been collecting Tax dollars from our community based on these perks for a number of years. Or have they not? I along with many others made a decision to invest here in this community and the county long term for the hope of an increased property value. How will this affect my property value?

The proposed land is close to a provincial recreation area. Many people from all over come there to boat, fish, paddle and sail to escape the industrial noise, air and light pollutants. Knowing what the land change is intended for has me greatly concerned about the future of our waterway as well as many other environmental impacts to wildlife in the area,

Emergency services- Who will provide paid emergency services and what costs or potential taxes would be needed to fund permanent positions rather than voluntary as well as specialized equipment chemical handling requirements that come with industrial fires, spills and rescue situations. Right now we have one road in and one road out for a large community and the potential for disaster is right at our entrance and exit to my home.

With Industry comes construction. We have already had to deal with a number of construction projects in the area. To say that it is a nuisance is an understatement. The Construction work creates major disruption to life. Noise, dust, heavy equipment, increased traffic and people to the area threatens security for residents. If the land use change was to happen it could set a precedent for further industrialization in the area. The thought of ongoing construction for years on end would further erode the residential and recreational nature of our community.

To conclude this is more than just a planning matter. It's about protecting our homes, our quality of life, If this change is allowed to happen it would have an irreversible impact, and change the character of our community permanently.

I respectfully ask Council to reject Land Use Bylaw 2026-007 and to protect the lake community from the potential inappropriate industrial development /(" AI data center")

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,
Clayton Stokes

From: [Clan bear](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Cc: [REDACTED]
Subject: Land use change 2026-07
Date: June 2, 2026 6:49:40 PM

[REDACTED]
<https://aka.ms/LearnAboutSenderIdentification>]

Good morning,

I have some concerns about the land use change application by Palliser Grid. My primary concern is safety. There's only one exit in case of a fire or emergency, and the land is close to several recreation areas. This will negatively impact both residents and visitors. Wildlife, fish, birds, and amphibians will also be affected. If the land is used for an AI data centre, there will be a significant increase in noise and air pollution. Light pollution will also impact stargazing and the visibility of the full moon. Furthermore, since many farmers in the area use irrigation systems, there will be an impact on both water cleanliness and availability. I want to leave a legacy for my children and grandchildren—a peaceful, quiet place for them to enjoy their lives.

Respectfully,
Connie and Wayne Burndred
Sent from my iPad

From: [REDACTED]
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026-007
Date: June 3, 2026 11:10:32 AM
Attachments: [Objection to rezoning - bylaw 2026-007.pdf](#)

[REDACTED]

Please find attached my objection to the land rezoning, per bylaw 2026-007.

Could you confirm receipt of this email.

Regards

Derek

Derek Wartier

[REDACTED]

My name is Derek Warltier and I have been an owner at Little Bow Resort for nearly thirty years. I wish to register my objection to this rezoning application (2026-007) in that it has the potential to increase the light pollution, the noise pollution, atmospheric pollutants (Nitrous Oxides, Sulphur Oxides, particulates etc.) and, more critically, for a frequently drought-stricken area of farmland, the heat pollution. Rezoning this land to industrial has the potential to release huge amounts of heat into the atmosphere and will make it more difficult for local farmers to conduct their business without huge quantities of additional water, due to the heat island.

Firstly, I would like to address the notion that this Public Hearing is simply about rezoning the affected parcel of land from Rural General to Rural Industrial. The Applicant has been very up-front about the purpose and intent of this rezoning. If this land gets rezoned, the Applicant intends to build a massive AI Data Processing Centre. There is no Plausible Deniability here. If Vulcan County Council votes in favour of changing the zoning, they are directly voting in favour of allowing pristine Alberta farmland to be turned into an major industrial complex, per the applicant's documentation.

I would like to address some of the items in the supporting documents (<https://www.vulcancounty.ab.ca/document/6505/>). In Section 9.2 of this document, the Applicant has indicated a target noise level of 45 dBA nighttime at the nearest residence. However, the Vulcan County Land Use Bylaw No 2020-028, consolidated to Bylaw 2025-027, July 2025, Section 43.5, page 243, indicates that "At all times during operation of the Data Processing operation, noise compliance shall be:" 40 dBA nighttime for Category 1. The property just North of the proposed rezoning area is significantly more than 500m from both Highways 531 and Highway 529. Range Road 212 cannot be classified as a "Heavily Travelled Road" so this property falls into Category 1, not Category 2. The proposal should be re-submitted using the correct noise levels (40 dBA nighttime).

The applicant intends to build sufficient Diesel generating capacity and Diesel storage to allow operation for 72 hours, without other sources of power. Ignoring the Power Utilization Factor, the required Diesel storage on-site is possibly 43.2 million litres (Section 6.3 Backup power and diesel storage screening). Storing this amount of Diesel so close to Travers Reservoir (a significant drinking water source) in a tank at elevation above the reservoir is a significant environmental risk. In addition, it is likely that all the Diesel stored at this facility will have crossed the end of the Travers Reservoir in a tanker truck (possibly several hundred). This causeway between the reservoirs is at the bottom of a hill on a sharp bend. A tanker overturning is another potential source of an environmental disaster.

From: [Eric](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw No 2026-007
Date: June 2, 2026 10:24:28 PM

To: County of Vulcan Council

Re: Objection to proposed Bylaw No 2026-007

I am writing with regards to the Vulcan County Land Use Amendment 2026-007 to redesignate Section 14-15-21 W4 and portions of E ½ 15-15-21 W4 ("the Land") from "Rural General – RG" to "Rural Industrial – RI".

The Vulcan County Council should not go ahead with this bylaw amendment for the following reasons:

1) According to Vulcan County bylaws, industrial uses are only permitted if "they do not pose a threat to the environment or create a nuisance for residents."

Portions of the Land are only 1.25 miles from Little Bow Resort ("LBR") and the Southern Alberta Bible Camp ("SABC"). LBR is a recreational community with over two hundred lots and a large number of year-round residents. SABC provides camping & lodging facilities for thousands of young campers & guests every year. The Land is in direct view of both properties; and is directly across from the access road to LBR and SABC. Any industrial project built on the Land will impact the safety of the existing communities and thousands of children during the summer. Redesignating the Land to RI would be irresponsible without taking these factors into consideration.

The Land is right next to Travers Reservoir, which is an Environmentally Significant Area on Crown land https://albertaparks.ca/media/3194487/esa_ab_vol1.pdf. The Land is also close to the Travers Reservoir Provincial Recreation Area and the Travers Dam Campground which is also used by hundreds of campers during the summer. Alberta Parks' own website describes the Recreation Area as having expansive views in all directions; and as a wonderful place for stargazing on clear nights <https://www.albertaparks.ca/parks/south/travers-reservoir-pra/information-facilities>.

The Land is too close to Recreational & Tourism points of interest. Rezoning the Land and allowing large industrial projects will have a direct adverse impact on the safety, enjoyment, and reputation of nearby LBR, SABC, Travers Dam Campground & the Travers Reservoir. It will certainly create a nuisance.

2) The Vulcan County's webpage states that the proposed amendment (Bylaw 2026-007) is "strictly for consideration to rezone the Land to allow for an application to be submitted within the framework of the Rural Industrial Land Use District", and "is not a development application for a Data Processing Operation."

However, the application by Palliser Grid for a land use bylaw amendment specifically states that the reason for the amendment is for an AI Data Centre Campus. Furthermore, in the Vulcan County Council meeting on March 11, 2026, the Council itself also states that the purpose of the proposed rezoning is to allow development of an AI Data Center. As the intended purpose is part of the Council's own documents, I think that Council has a legal, ethical & moral obligation to consider the proposed purpose before approving the rezoning request. Numerous arguments have already been raised by other stakeholders against the construction of an AI Data Centers due to the noise, air & light pollution, high water & power consumption, and other environmental concerns.

Regardless, the Council should not approve rezoning of this Land for ANY industrial use. Rural Industrial uses include a wide variety of industries. In addition to AI data centers, a land use change would permit auto salvage yards, cannabis production facilities, storage compounds, compost facilities, or even worse for all the surrounding parties – a livestock slaughterhouse. Any industrial project would be far too close to the recreational & environmental areas mentioned above.

3) In a recent Calgary Herald article on April 7, 2026, land owner Eric Steeves stated “local farmers will get the first shot at investing in his proposed facility and that local “farmers need to look for opportunities to provide jobs or another source of revenue in the area”. AI Data Centers of the proposed size take several billions of dollars to build. Mr. Steeves & local farmers will not have the capital required to build an AI Data Center project of this size. It seems much more likely that if Mr. Steeves obtains the necessary approvals for the project to become viable then a tech giant like Microsoft or Amazon would likely purchase the Land, in which case it will not necessarily provide any revenue source for the other farmers & stakeholders in the area.

On another note, rezoning this Land for Rural Industrial may create a dangerous precedent for future land use changes in all Vulcan County. What criteria did the Council use in approving the rezoning of the land to RI? Whatever justification is used to rezone this Land can then be used to industrialize other farm properties. What would then stop someone from purchasing rural land a couple of miles outside the town of Vulcan, having it first rezoned, and then filing a development permit to build a feedlot or slaughterhouse there?

Thank you for your time. Let me know if you have any questions or comments regarding any of the above.

Sincerely,

Eric Willerth

██████████ Little Bow Resort

██████████

From: [H Kostick](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Submission for June 10 public hearing
Date: June 2, 2026 8:33:35 PM
Attachments: [June 10 submission to Public Hearing for Vulcan County bylaw change 2026-007 Kostick.docx](#)

Hello

Please accept and confirm receipt of my submission for the June 10 Public Hearing re: bylaw change 2026-007.

Thank you,
Heidi Kostick

To: Vulcan County Council

May 31, 2026

Subject: Opposition to land use by-law change 2026-007 Rural General (RG) to Rural Industrial (RI), Palliser Grid proposed AI data centre campus.

I am a resident of Little Bow Resort writing to express my opposition to the proposed land use change from rural general to rural industrial. My concerns relate to loss of agricultural land, environmental impacts, compliance with Area Structure Plans, safety issues, creating a nuisance, as well as risks to the reservoir and surrounding areas and wildlife.

While I am not opposed to development, I strongly feel that this application should not be accepted in the area council is considering.

I do want to express my disappointment in this public hearing being held at 1:00 pm during the work week. Holding the hearing at this time of day/week makes it very difficult for many to attend, including myself.

Loss of Agricultural Land

The application would remove productive agricultural land. Agricultural land is a limited and valuable resource, especially in this region where farming remains a core economic driver. The County should be protecting agricultural land, not fragmenting it with further industrial development.

Environmentally Sensitive Areas and Wetlands

This site is located near environmentally sensitive areas. It also includes wetlands and grasslands. Disturbance to wetlands can permanently damage water quality, wildlife habitat, and natural drainage systems. Without formal wetland assessments and a biodiversity impact report, this land should not be changed to industrial.

Highway 529 is already showing signs of heaving as you drive near the spillway. These changes suggest there is likely seepage underneath between this land and the spillway/Travers reservoir. This would increase the risk of contamination of the underground water, the reservoir, and further weaken the structure of the highway. Never mind the effects of the massive increase in traffic (heavy trucks, including fuel trucks) travelling on this highway.

Municipal Development Plan:

Section 2.7 Natural Environment

2.7.1 The County shall endeavour to protect environmentally significant areas (as per the report, “Environmentally Significant Areas in the Oldman River Region” completed for Vulcan County in 1988), and other significant natural areas and resources from inappropriate development.

For reasons provided in my submission, this application violates the above section.

Wildlife Impacts

This land supports wildlife including eagles, owls, raptors, as well as other species at risk. Industrial developments create issues such as light pollution, noise, and destroy wildlife habitat. For example, light pollution is known to disrupt bird migration and nesting behavior. For this reason, the land should not be rezoned industrial.

Risk to Reservoir and Water Quality

The site is positioned above the reservoir spillway. Any contamination – fuel, chemicals, coolant, or runoff could drain toward the reservoir. The reservoir is a critical resource for irrigation, drinking water, fish, vegetation, and wildlife. Any risk to the above would be catastrophic. For this reason, the land in question should not be industrial.

Water Use Concerns

This region has experienced significant drought in recent years and will suffer more drought conditions in the future. I question how and why water would be approved for a data centre. Who has precedence for water use when we face our next drought – agriculture or industry? Existing residential areas are entitled to safe drinking water.

Areas fed by the Bow River are already facing water restrictions. How can industry that will take an extremely high amount of water from a source already struggling be given access to large amounts of water?

I draw your attention to the following policies in the Municipal Development Plan. Again, I encourage The County to consider their own policies when considering this land use change application.

WATER MANAGEMENT POLICIES:

2.7.8 The County recognizes the importance of maintaining the existing reservoirs as a source of high-quality water. The County shall control development adjacent to the reservoir to protect the supply and quality of water. In particular, all applications for

confined feeding operations, development or subdivision applications and land use amendment applications will be reviewed to ensure the **protection of the quality and quantity of water from these reservoirs.**

2.7.10 The County recognizes the critical importance of water resources and the need for **sustainable management of these resources into the future.** The protection of the available water supply will be a consideration in the review of all land use and development matters.

2.7.11 Southern Alberta has experienced **severe drought conditions** in recent years and The County recognizes the need to work with partners, including other levels of government, irrigation districts, and advisory bodies like the Oldman Watershed Council and the Bow River Basin Council in monitoring drought conditions and advancing water management solutions for the future.

- The above policies create insight into the drought conditions we continue to face. The large use of water from Travers Reservoir included in the application puts our area and others at further risk.

Area Structure Plan (ASP) Policies and bylaw Conflicts

Policy 7.2 of the ASP states that future development should be supported as long as proposed development **does not negatively impact existing development or environmentally sensitive areas.**

Policy 7.2.3 states that **new industrial development should not negatively impact adjacent development.**

Section 8.1 of the ASP emphasizes: **maximizing recreational opportunities afforded by the reservoirs and protecting the integrity of the rural landscape.**

Vulcan County's Land Use Bylaw No. 2020-028, Rural Industrial - RI states that its purpose is "to allow industrial uses to be located in rural areas **provided they do not pose a threat to the environment or create a potential nuisance for residents**".

I draw your attention to the policies above as they relate to this land use change and ai data centre campus proposal. It is a fact that noise and light pollution are a nuisance to wildlife, humans, and the area as a whole. Data centres bring noise and light pollution which will affect wildlife and residents, among other issues. A development of the size proposed will be extremely large and a massive visual disturbance in close proximity to nearby areas. The Applicant's suggestion of a berm would not be possible in order to block the view of this proposed development.

It is my opinion that reasons included in this submission are proof that allowing this land use change would be in direct conflict with The County's own ASP and MDP.

Proximity to Recreational Area

Section 13.1 (Industrial Siting Standards) A proposed grouped industrial developments or an isolated industrial development considered by the Development Authority to be **potentially hazardous, unsightly, or offensive should not be approved within 1.6 km (1 mile)** of:

A: an incorporated urban municipality

B: a hamlet

C: a provincial regional, municipal park or recreation area

D: an environmentally significant area

E: an existing or approved rural residence.

The land in question is less than 1.6km from a provincial recreation area, a rural residence, and an environmentally significant area. The application is inconsistent with the planning principles of The County. In order to remain compliant, this land must not be rezoned as industrial.

Cumulative Industrial Impacts

This area has already experienced significant industrial development, including large solar and wind projects. The cumulative industrialization of this area has already changed the rural landscape dramatically. We must value and preserve these lands for reasons such as agriculture, wildlife, the environment, and protected areas.

Safety

Security, safety, and fire are all increased risks with items listed in the application such as battery storage and diesel backup generators. It is known that Alberta will not grant power to more data centres. A large power plant would have to be added as part of this development.

There is not sufficient access to or training of emergency service personnel in this area. The recent fire at the solar farm reflects the risks of a fire that could not be handled well and quickly. The application would bring an extreme increase in risk to the safety of nearby residents. Namely, the Southern Alberta Bible Camp, an individual residence, as well as

Little Bow Resort. A fire or explosion could spread rapidly, be extremely difficult to control, and the residents nearby have no safe exit. In fact, they would have to drive towards the danger in order to exit - even if a new road were built for secondary access.

The extreme risk to the lives of hundreds of children at the nearby Southern Alberta Bible Camp and the residents of Little Bow Resort should be reason enough to not approve this application.

Information showing an increase of hundreds of trucks per day (for construction and fuel hauling) on the roadway increases the risk to everyone travelling.

There is only one small hospital nearby. With the amount of development and construction proposed, there is no doubt it would put a strain on the system. Everyone will suffer from lack of access to safe and reasonable care in a timely manner.

Closing

In closing, it is evident that this application for a land use change from RG to RI is in direct violation of local bylaws and policies, the Area Structure Plan, Municipal Development Plan, environmental protections, and would bring increased risks to residents nearby. It will impact wetlands, biodiversity, wildlife, water, riparian lands and affect protected bird areas. It would create an increased burden on our emergency services and significantly increase the cumulative impacts of industry in this area.

I also stress that though this hearing is for consideration of a land use change, The County has included The Proponent, Palliser Grid's, proposal for an AI data centre campus on this land. For this reason, The County must take into consideration all arguments that mention the proposed development. They cannot disregard any part of this submission or others.

I do ask that Vulcan Country strongly consider **denying** bylaw land-use change 2026-007.

Sincerely,

Heidi Kostick

██████ Lakeside Drive, Little Bow Resort

From: [Hugh Stirling](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Cc: [Hugh Stirling](#); [connie lupescu](#)
Subject: Proposed bylaw 2026-007
Date: June 3, 2026 6:46:35 AM

Good Morning

I sent a previous with thee incorrect dates please accept this one as its replacement

Good morning,

We are writing as property owners at Little Bow Resort to formally object to proposed Bylaw 2026-007 which we understand will redesignate approximately 850 acres of Rural General use land to Rural industrial use land to allow a large scale Data Processing Plant.

We have significant concerns about the location of this project in such close proximity to Little Bow Resort and the Traverse Reservoir waterways. This area is a quiet, recreational and natural area and this project would totally change the environment

Our concerns are:

Noise from the plant affecting both the resident and wildlife in the area.

Water usage which will affect wetlands, waterways and irrigation
Increased traffic putting strains on an already busy roadway
Visual and Light Pollution

We do not believe this is the proper location for this project as it seems not to be compatible with the area.

We aren't aware of any short or long term impact environmental studies or noise studies that have been done and we ask that a lot more information be made available before the application to redesignate the land is reviewed.

We would like this letter to be part of the public hearing scheduled for June 3, 2026 at 1300 hrs. We are trying to rearrange things so that we may attend in person.

My wife and myself are against this project and ask you reconsider this project.

Thank you in advance,

Hugh Stirling and Connie Lupescu

 Sunset Dr

Little Bow Resort

From: [Jacquie Snider](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Opposition to Bylaw 2026-007 – Rural Industrial Rezone
Date: June 3, 2026 9:50:21 AM
Attachments: [Rezoning Letter June 3, 2026.docx](#)

[REDACTED]

Please find attached my opposition letter to the rezoning Bylaw 2026-007 for your records.

I do not wish to speak but would like my concerns part of the record for why this project should not be considered.

Please respond that this letter will be part of the record.

Regards
Jacquie Snider
[REDACTED] Lakeside Drive
Little Bow Resort
[REDACTED]

June 3, 2026

Vulcan County

devassist@vulcancounty.ab.ca

RE: Opposition to Bylaw 2026-007 – Rural Industrial Rezone Near Little Bow Resort

To Vulcan County Council,

I am writing to formally oppose Bylaw 2026-007, which proposes redesignating approximately 865 acres from Rural General (RG) to Rural Industrial (RI) near Lomond, Alberta.

As a resident and property owner at Little Bow Resort, I have serious concerns regarding the proposed redesignation and its potential impacts on the environment, nearby residents, property owners, and the long-term character of our community. I believe the proposed industrial zoning is incompatible with the existing agricultural, residential, and recreational nature of the area.

Impact on Little Bow Resort and the Lake Community

Little Bow Resort is an established residential and recreational lake community where families, retirees, and seasonal residents have invested significant time, resources, and personal commitment into their properties. Residents chose this area because of its quiet rural setting, natural beauty, recreational opportunities, and proximity to the lake.

The proposed redesignation to Rural Industrial represents a substantial change in land use that is fundamentally different from the agricultural and residential uses that currently characterize the area. Industrial zoning adjacent to a lake community creates uncertainty regarding future development and introduces the potential for conflicts between industrial operations and residential living.

The lake is a valuable community asset used for boating, fishing, swimming, wildlife observation, and family recreation. The peaceful environment that residents and visitors enjoy could be negatively affected by industrial development in close proximity to the community.

Concerns Regarding Water Quality and Environmental Protection

The proposed industrial lands are located within the broader area that influences the lake and surrounding environment. Industrial development carries an increased risk of contamination from stormwater runoff, fuel storage, construction activities, dust suppression products, equipment operation, and accidental spills.

Protecting water quality should be a priority for Vulcan County. Once contamination occurs, environmental damage can be difficult and expensive to reverse. Given the importance of the lake to residents, visitors, and wildlife, a precautionary approach should be taken before approving any industrial zoning nearby.

Fire Protection and Emergency Response Concerns

Little Bow Resort is located in an area where fire protection and emergency response capabilities are critical due to the concentration of homes, cabins, seasonal residents, and recreational users. Any large-scale industrial development has the potential to increase demands on emergency services through construction activities, electrical infrastructure, industrial equipment, increased traffic, and other operational risks.

Residents need assurance that existing fire protection resources will not be strained or diverted as a result of industrial development. Before any redesignation is approved, a comprehensive assessment should be conducted to determine the impact on local fire protection services, emergency response times, firefighting water supply requirements, and the capacity of emergency services to respond to both community and industrial incidents.

The safety of existing residents and property owners should not be compromised by introducing industrial land uses in close proximity to a residential lake community.

Limited Access and Evacuation Concerns

One of the most significant concerns for residents of Little Bow Resort is that the community effectively relies on a single primary access road for entry and exit.

This limited access creates challenges during emergency situations such as wildfires, severe weather events, industrial accidents, hazardous material incidents, or any event requiring a rapid evacuation. Increased industrial traffic associated with development could further affect the safe and efficient movement of residents, visitors, emergency vehicles, and first responders.

Before approving any industrial rezoning, Vulcan County should require a detailed traffic and emergency access study to evaluate:

- Emergency evacuation capacity for Little Bow Resort residents and visitors.
- The impact of industrial traffic on emergency response times.
- Potential conflicts between industrial vehicles and emergency services.
- Whether existing road infrastructure is adequate to support both industrial activity and public safety requirements.
- Contingency plans should the primary access route become blocked or unusable.

Residents should not face increased safety risks due to additional traffic and development pressures on a road network that already provides limited access to the community.

Loss of Agricultural Land

The redesignation would permanently remove a significant amount of agricultural land from agricultural use. Productive farmland is a valuable and limited resource that contributes to the local economy, food production, and rural character of Vulcan County.

Agricultural land once converted to industrial use is rarely returned to farming. Preserving these lands should remain a priority for future generations.

Increased Traffic and Infrastructure Pressures

Industrial development often results in increased truck traffic, employee commuting, service vehicles, and construction activity. This can create safety concerns, increase road maintenance costs, generate dust, and place additional strain on local infrastructure.

Residents of Little Bow Resort and surrounding areas currently enjoy relatively low traffic volumes and a quiet rural atmosphere. Increased industrial traffic would negatively affect that quality of life and may create additional hazards on roads.

Noise, Lighting, and Visual Impacts

Industrial operations frequently involve outdoor lighting, utility infrastructure, equipment operation, and activity that may occur around the clock. These impacts can significantly alter the rural landscape and affect nearby residents.

Excessive lighting can impact enjoyment of the lake area, diminish dark-sky conditions, and affect both residents and wildlife. Noise and visual impacts may further reduce the attractiveness of the area for recreation and residential living.

Property Value Concerns

Many property owners have made substantial investments in homes, cabins, and recreational properties based on the expectation that the surrounding area would remain agricultural and rural in character.

The introduction of industrial zoning near a residential lake community creates uncertainty and may negatively affect property values and the desirability of the area for future buyers, visitors, and potential investors in the community.

Precedent for Future Industrial Expansion

Approval of Bylaw 2026-007 may set a precedent for future industrial rezoning applications in the area. While the current proposal may be associated with a specific project, the Rural Industrial designation could open the door to additional industrial uses in the future.

Residents deserve certainty that the character of the area will be protected. Approving such a large industrial designation near Little Bow Resort raises concerns about the long-term direction of development in the region and the gradual industrialization of an area currently valued for agriculture, recreation, and residential use.

Incompatibility with the Existing Character of the Area

Little Bow Resort is not simply a collection of lots on a map. It is a community where families have built homes and cabins, invested their savings, and created lasting memories around the lake. The area is valued for its peaceful setting, natural environment, and recreational opportunities.

Industrial zoning may be appropriate in some locations within the county, but it is not appropriate adjacent to an established residential and recreational lake community. The proposed redesignation is inconsistent with the character of the area and risks undermining the qualities that make Little Bow Resort and the surrounding region unique.

Request

For the reasons outlined above, I respectfully request that Vulcan County Council deny Bylaw 2026-007 and retain the existing Rural General designation.

At a minimum, I request that Council require comprehensive environmental, groundwater, traffic, noise, lighting, fire protection, emergency access, evacuation, and community impact assessments before considering any approval. The interests of existing residents, property owners, lake users, and agricultural stakeholders should be given significant weight in this decision.

In addition to environmental and land-use concerns, Council must carefully consider the public safety implications of placing industrially zoned land near a residential lake community that relies on a single primary access route. Protecting residents, ensuring effective emergency response, preserving evacuation options, and maintaining the rural character of the area should be fundamental considerations in any decision regarding Bylaw 2026-007.

Thank you for your consideration of my concerns and for your commitment to protecting the long-term interests of the residents and communities of Vulcan County.

Respectfully submitted

Jacquie Snider (owner)

[REDACTED] Lakeside Drive Little Bow Resort
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

From: [Jadeen Umscheid](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026-007
Date: June 3, 2026 8:56:29 AM

To whom it may concern,

I am writing to express my opposition to the proposed development of an AI data center in Vulcan County.

Vulcan County is an agricultural community, and our future depends on reliable access to water. Farmers, ranchers, and irrigation districts already face increasing pressure from drought conditions, growing demand, and uncertainty surrounding future water supplies. Water is not an unlimited resource, and every decision regarding its use must consider the long-term needs of agriculture and the people who depend on it. Our farms and ranches produce food, support local businesses, create jobs, and form the backbone of the county's economy and identity.

Once water resources are committed to large industrial projects, there is a real risk that future agricultural growth and water security could be compromised. Given the challenges already facing Southern Alberta's water supply, it is difficult to justify allocating significant amounts of water to an AI data center when farmers are continually asked to do more with less. As the wife of a farmer with a section of irrigation I have witnessed reductions in the amount of water allocated for irrigation over the years. We can't afford to lose more.

Council has a responsibility to protect the resources that sustain this county for future generations. Water should be reserved first and foremost for agriculture, food production, and the residents who call Vulcan County home.

Respectfully,

Jadeen Umscheid

From: [Jane Hawkins](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Proposed Bylaw No 2026-007
Date: June 2, 2026 9:41:54 PM

By this correspondence, I give notice of my objection in regard to the re-designation of the Section 14 and portions of the East Half 15-15-21 W4M as proposed (By-Law number 2026-007), Rural Industrial from Rural General. The reasons for my objection are three fold.

Firstly, the Application materials are deficient as they fail to provide any evidence that the Data Centre proposed to be constructed on these lands does “not pose a threat to the environment or create a potential nuisance for residents”.

Secondly, the Application materials are silent as to why the site chosen by the Applicant is an appropriate location for such an industrial facility.

Finally, I have concerns that if the lands are re-zoned and no Data Centre is constructed, the new zoning will allow the Applicant to use the lands for any or all industrial uses he deems appropriate, without any municipal zoning oversight.

Thank you, Jane Hawkins

From: [Jason Gouw](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Cc: [Jlgouw](#)
Subject: Opposition to proposed Bylaw No. 2026-007
Date: June 3, 2026 8:57:51 AM
Attachments: [landsolutions_logo-main-smallsize_e5c6f011-0b3c-473d-ad3e-eac23bc8309e.png](#)
[Opposition to proposed Bylaw No. 2026-007.pdf](#)

[REDACTED]

To whom it may concern,

I am writing to you to strongly oppose proposed Bylaw No. 2026-007 to redesignate Section 14 and portions of E1/2 15-15-21 W4 containing approximately 350± ha (865± acres) from “Rural General – RG” to “Rural Industrial – RI”.

Please see attached letter stating my objection and outlining my concerns.

Sincerely,

Jason Gouw

[REDACTED]

Jason Gouw

[REDACTED]

LandSolutions 

[REDACTED]

June 2, 2026

Re: Opposition to proposed Bylaw No. 2026-007

Dear Members of Council,

I am writing to you to strongly oppose proposed Bylaw No. 2026-007 to redesignate Section 14 and portions of E1/2 15-15-21 W4 containing approximately 350± ha (865± acres) from “Rural General – RG” to “Rural Industrial – RI”. The purpose of the proposed amendment is to develop the property in accordance with the provisions of the Rural Industrial Land Use District (the Project).

I, along with my wife and children are parttime residents of Little Bow Resort (LBR) since 2009. My objection stems from significant concern for the safety of LBR residents, the children and volunteers who are in attendance at Southern Alberta Bible Camp (SABC). During the summer months (mid June to mid September) there are as many as 1,000 people at LBR on weekends in addition to the hundreds of children attending SABC.

While we have many concerns including proximity to Travers reservoir, environmental sensitivities and the negative impact on local infrastructure, my primary safety concern is the risk of a fire and the existing evacuation options for the area which are very limited. The area’s most recent grassfire, at the Travers Solar site on March 7th, 2026 was significant enough that it was attended by fire services of several local communities. The exact location was confirmed as starting in the solar panels on the SE 7-15-20W4. The fire conditions on that day were moderate yet the fire still exhibited fast-moving behavior and jumped RGE RD 205, consuming approximately 160 acres before it was contained. This same fire during a summer drought could have been significantly more impactful.

The Project is proposing to utilize a Battery Energy Storage System (BESS). Fires from lithium-ion batteries are known to burn at very high temperatures, release toxic gases, re-ignite after appearing controlled and to be more difficult and hazardous to fight.

There is a single point of egress from the SABC & Little Bow Resort which creates a dangerous bottleneck. A fire travelling at the speed of the Travers Solar site fire could reach the egress point (the intersection of Highway 529 and Range Road 212) within a few minutes, completely blocking off access to the highway and trapping everyone at SABC and Little Bow Resort. Consequently, there is significant public safety risk to residents, visitors, and children attending camp activities.

The proposed Project will also create a safety nuisance through the emissions of noise, smoke, dust, odour, heat, light, fire hazard, etc. See Administrative Definitions of a Nuisance – Vulcan County Land Use Bylaw 2020-028 as per below:

NUISANCE means anything that is obnoxious, offensive or interferes with the use or enjoyment of property, endangers personal health and safety, or is offensive to the senses. This could include that which creates or is liable to create a nuisance through emission of noise, smoke, dust, odour, heat, light, fumes, vibration, fire or explosive hazard; results in the unsightly or unsafe storage of goods, salvage, junk, waster or other material; or poses a hazard to health and safety.

Section 13.1 of the Vulcan County Land Use Bylaw further provides that industrial developments shall not be potentially hazardous where located near sensitive or populated areas.

In addition to fire concerns, is the risk of traffic accidents. During construction of the Project, hundreds of vehicles related to the site, including heavy truck traffic, will drive highway 529 weekly. This will create an increased risk of accidents particularly at the LBR/SABC access road (Range Road 212 and Highway 529) given the poor site lines facing turning west (left) onto highway 529.

In summary, as stated above, I am adamantly opposed to the proposed Bylaw No. 2026-007 to redesignate Section 14 and portions of E1/2 15-15-21 W4 containing approximately 350± ha (865± acres) from “Rural General – RG” to “Rural Industrial – RI” due to the reasons provided above.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to be 'Jason Gouw', with a long horizontal stroke extending to the right.

Jason Gouw
[REDACTED] Lakeside Drive, LBR
[REDACTED]

From: [Karen Cowan](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Objection to proposed Bylaw 2026-007 Rezoning Application
Date: June 3, 2026 11:39:16 AM

[REDACTED]
<https://aka.ms/LearnAboutSenderIdentification>]

As everyone is aware, there is only a set amount of land that can be used for agriculture and once changed to industrial cannot be reversed back to agricultural. There has been far too much land in this county rezoned to industrial which has negatively impacted the water resources, air pollution and wildlife along with the residents of this county.

This proposed change from rural agriculture to rural industrial is in non-compliance with Vulcan County Land Use law No. 2020-028 Schedule 2 - R1, Section 13.1.

The proposed industrial section is within 1.6 km of a provincial, regional , municipal park or recreation area, within 1.6km of an environmentally significant area, within 1.6km of an existing rural residence and within 1.6km of an approved rural residence.

Therefore I am requesting that the County of Vulcan immediately cease pursuing rezoning of these lands to RI, to avoid damages to nearby land owners, water source and wildlife that would most certainly occur if the lands were rezoned to RI in contravention of Land Use Bylaws.

Yours Truly,
Karen Cowan & Anil Narinedat
[REDACTED] Lakeside Drive
Little Bow Resort
Vulcan County, AB
[REDACTED]

Sent from my iPad

From: [Kelly Warrack](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Proposed Bylaw No. 2026-007
Date: June 3, 2026 9:48:32 AM
Attachments: [Vulcan County Bylaw 2026-007.pdf](#)

[REDACTED]

Attached please find my letter related to the noted matter.
Thank you.

--

Kelly Warrack

[REDACTED] [REDACTED] Ogden | Calgary | AB | T2C 3W5 | Canada
[REDACTED] [REDACTED]

Vulcan County
PO Box 180
Vulcan, AB
T0L 2B0

RE: PROPOSED BYLAW NO. 2026-007

In regard to the proposed By-Law number 2026-007, I oppose the application to rezone the east half of Section 15 and all of Section 14, in Township 15, Range 21, West of the 4th Meridian to Rural Industrial from Rural General.

Mr. Steeves' Application has been made prematurely. He has provided no facts which ought to convince the County of Vulcan that the above-described lands are an appropriate site for such an industrial facility. He has failed to provide any evidence that the adjacent "environmentally significant" area ought to bare the consequences of having an intensive industrial facility "next door". He has not given the County any information concerning the light and noise pollution which his proposed Data Centre would cause, nor the effect of that pollution, either short term or long term, who make their homes on or adjacent to those lands.

In Wheatland County a subdivision application was initially denied because one person thought they had seen a protected bird in the area. However, in the County of Vulcan, an entire habitat is left vulnerable because one farmer believes that his lands are an appropriate site for one of Alberta's largest industrial sites, without any evidence to back the impacts of such a re-designation.

More environmental studies and compelling evidence are required prior to any re-designation of the lands in question.

Regards,

Kelly Warrack

From: lydiamerkel28@gmail.com
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026-007
Date: June 3, 2026 10:38:49 AM
Attachments: [AI DATA CENTRE.pdf](#)

hello
re: AI Data Centre

My husband and I have owned property at Little Bow Resort since 1997, We bought here because of the clean lake.

We have enjoyed raising our family there. It is very peaceful and quiet. We enjoy the beauty of wild life. Our plan was to retire there, which is now less than 5 years away.

I have been researching AI DATA CENTRES to educate myself on the pro's and con's.

First off, there is a massive amount of information to go through. I, personally, don't feel enough time was given to people to make an informed yay or nay decision.

I understand that is the wave of our future, however we do not feel that the proposed site is an appropriate site for industrial rezoning or an AI Data Centre due to the proximity of the lake, nearby residences, environment and infrastructure concerns.

Nonetheless I will do my best to focus on the entire project

see attached documentation. Items of concern are randomly listed.

thank you,

Lydia & Darrin Merkel
[REDACTED] Sunset Drive
Little Bow Resort
[REDACTED]

AI DATA CENTRE

These are areas we would like more transparency on:

- What is the Environmental Design?
- Is there a Water protection plan
- More info on the sealed, closed loop cooling system.
- How much water is used?
- How often is it changed?
- Where is 'dirty water' disposed?
- What is the power demand?
- Is it energy efficient ?
- Our area is prone to power outages, how will this affect the centre?
- Our area is also prone to drought which is when the lake is used for irrigation or fires. The lake is usually low until August.
- Does the centre have its' own fire protection onsite?
- Noise pollution from cooling systems and backup generators
- Visual impact
- exterior lighting plan
- traffic and construction
- How long would the construction last?
- Infrastructure impacts such as roads and servicing
- More info on the gas plant needed.
- How is the Data Centre monitored??
- Management Strategy?
- carbon emissions?
- Will the county have financial security from the developer ?
- Will the centre have monitored Security??
- What is the centres Air Pollution & Local Health Impacts?
- The research indicates a single, data center may adversely affect the health of those living at least 0.6-miles away and possibly miles further under some circumstance. Little Bow is within that range.

SEE NEXT PAGE

NOTE: Toxic Trash Dump

The servers, chips, and other computing components inside data centers are destined for the trash in just a handful of years. Meanwhile, global electronic waste (e-waste) recycling systems are not even close to catching up to this new glut of trash. Less than 25% of e-waste gets recycled globally.

routinely exposed to heavy metals like lead, mercury, and cadmium, which are linked to a host of health harms,

From: [Maureen Hawkins](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Proposed Bylaw Number 2026-007
Date: June 3, 2026 8:41:41 AM

The County of Vulcan has duties to its residents and to all Albertans, to consider its own Bylaws when reviewing the application by Palliser Grid in Bylaw 2026-007. The County bylaws require its Councillors to consider whether any site is appropriate for the development proposed, whether a development in any site would cause negative impacts or hazards to other County residents or others, whether a proposed development would be harmful to the environment, whether a development would negatively affect an environmentally sensitive area or whether a development would negatively affect a recreational area.

The development proposed by Palliser Grid would cause all of those effects yet the County Councillors are moving to consider the application without any evidence from the proponent about those effects. Had the proponent applied to construct a home or a garage, the county would seek evidence from an architect or an engineer in the form of a stamp. That stamp would provide the County with the evidence required that the home or garage would meet County and Provincial standards.

In the above-noted application, the County wishes to consider the Application without evidence as to any harm the development could cause. Mr. Steeves suggests that Palliser Grid will contribute to local sports and community initiatives. How does he propose to contribute to the waterfowl and other animals that will be adversely affected by a development of the size and scale suggested, as all, or some of those animals live in the adjacent “environmentally sensitive” areas surrounding. Has he provided any evidence from experts in the field as to how Palliser Grid could abate the negative effects of an unsightly, offensive, possibly toxic, land development?

In fact, Palliser Grid has provided no evidence. Their only promise is that the development intended, through redesignation, will bring tax revenues to the County. I believe that the County should consider such an application but that the proponent ought to prove viability of the proposed site, both for short term and the long term negative impacts. Once this Genie is out of the lantern, there is no putting it back! This type of application to redesignate farmland into a very large industrial swath should be carefully and thoughtfully wriggled.

I believe that when properly considered, the application will be found wanting. It ought to be situated elsewhere, not adjacent to wetlands, a lake, residents and a community residential development, as well as potable water source for many.

Please consider Mr. Steeves’ application, on behalf of Palliser Grid, to be insufficient as it lacks evidence and the necessary facts required to make an informed decision. Promises are not scientific nor are they based upon facts. We, as a community rely on you, as our elected Council to make sound decisions and this application is lacking the required information for you make an informed decision and therefore Council should deny this application.

Thank you,
Maureen Hawkins

From: [Morley Myden](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Public Meeting for Bylaw 2026-007
Date: June 3, 2026 8:10:20 AM
Attachments: [AI Data Centre - June 2, 2026.pdf](#)


<https://aka.ms/LearnAboutSenderIdentification>]

Please include the attached document in your Public hearing documents for Bylaw 2026-007

Thank you,
Morley Myden

Morley Myden
[REDACTED], Lakeside Drive
Little Bow Resort, Vulcan County

June 2, 2026

Vulcan County Council
102 Centre Street
Vulcan, Alberta
T0L 2B0
Delivered via email to devassist@vulcancounty.ab.ca

RE: Public Hearing for Bylaw 2026-007

I am writing this letter to object to the proposed Bylaw 2026-007

There is a lot of information to unpack in the submission from Paradise Grid. I found most of the submission still very vague which given amount of time that the proponent had. It lacks in information as compared to many other AI Data Centre proposals in the province.

It is also concerning that the proponent has not wanted to have any meaningful community discussions with the public in general. Many of the other provincial AI Data Centre proponents have had community forums and events to show what their plans were. This has not taken place in any formal fashion so the existing proposal does not contain any feedback from the community at large.

What follows is some analysis of the potential project.

First, I want to start or preface with a personal statement regarding this area in Vulcan County.

Preface:

I have been an owner at Little Bow Resort (LBR) for 14 years. I was trying to think how best to describe why Travers Reservoir and the surrounding area is special. I truly believe that Travers is the premier lake recreational area in Southern Alberta.

When I drive from Calgary and make the turn at Champion to head east to LBR, I often try to take the time and look around. We are in one of the nicest locations in Canada. Heading east are fields and rolling hills. Looking back to the west are open spaces and mountain vistas. The drive relaxes you. Fields of canola are especially beautiful when they are flowering. Yellow goes on forever. Rolling hills, tiny creek beds, coulees and valleys. Cattle and horses along the fence lines. Often you can see a couple deer or if you are lucky a huge herd of 50 or more. Almost always a hawk on a post or circling above looking for a meal. About halfway to the resort you come up a hill and as you crest it you see that simmering silver, blue lake. Our family dog used to go crazy when he saw that. The lake was his favourite place too. Then down the valley and across the canal, of course looking to see if it is running full. The resort is in full view and the temperature gauge on your vehicle has gone up. I find it always 2 to 5 degrees warmer at the lake than in Calgary. You have arrived at LBR. It is peaceful and very special.

Often in the early morning hours the lake is “like glass”. Periodically, a Loon’s call can be heard. Pelicans, ducks and other waterfowl also share the lake with us. The first people out on the lake are the fishermen racing to the spillway. As we know fishing is pretty darn good. Travers is a clean and clear lake. I have been traveling on a Seadoo and have had no problem seeing fish swimming about 3-4 feet down. There are lots of activities to be done on or at the lake. Great camping facilities, public beaches, sandy shore spots to stop for a swim. The Bible Camp where hundreds of kids get to enjoy the lake every summer.

In the evening when it is a clear night and after the sun goes down, star gazing is common. There is very little light pollution. Sometimes you can hear a coyote howling on the other side of the lake.

These are just a few of the things we enjoy at the lake.

Travers Reservoir and the surrounding area is one of Vulcan County’s Crown Jewels.

To me, the Land use change request and the accompanying proposal for development has a few angles to look at it. In general, it would be an increase to the County’s tax base, which is good. It will also mean changing the whole area look and feel and comes with environment concerns too. I know there is a benefit to Paradise Grid. There is a net negative benefit for LBR and other residents that are directly in the line of sight of the proposed lands. There is no question that this will be a large industrial complex that has to operate 365 days per year, 24 hours per day.

The other major thing to think about and this may be one of the most important ones...Does this area meet a Data Centre’s requirements? They need access to highly skilled people, very high-speed fiber optic cables, close as possible to user communities. These things are all typically in larger urban centres. I discuss that a little more below.

Executive Summary:

It is not my duty nor concern to point out benefits, if any, of the proposed AI Data Centre. That should be up to the proponent.

There are significant cons to this project and I will point out some but not all of them:

- **Power Availability and Reliability:** The most critical factor data centres need access to high-voltage power grids. This location has no access to the power required. It appears the proponent is suggesting to build a Substation to bring in power from the Alberta grid or some other location. The provincial government has made it clear that there is no “grid power” available for data centres. Data centres must provide their own power generation. Therefore to run this data centre, the proponent will have to build a Power Plant which will most likely have to be natural gas turbines. This power plant will bring many significant issues.

- The proponent says the site will have a maximum height of 12 metres. With a natural gas fired power plant the height will reach roughly 22 stories which is 60+ metres high.
- A natural gas fired power plant produces significant carbon pollution. Although natural gas is a transition fuel it still produces about 70% of the carbon of a coal fired plant. Without carbon capture or some other form of mitigation this will contribute a lot of air pollution to the area and province.
- The proponent says the construction period is two (2) years for Phase I and that is without a power plant. Since this is a proposed for a Four Phase project we can assume this will mean a minimum of eight (8) years of construction on the site.
- The proponent estimates that there will be 200 trucks per day on the highway for two (2) years to build Phase I of the data centre. The truck traffic per day will significantly increase if a power plant is now included in the site build. According to the proposed plan we can assume we will have at least 8 years of construction traffic at 300-400 trucks per day,
- **Visual, Noise, Height and Water concerns.** A power plant also brings noise and light pollution with it as well as significant height differences. It may also bring further water requirements depending on design.

- **Climate and Cooling Requirements:** If everything else were equal at a competing site, a cooler climate would be preferable for “free cooling”. This is the reason many data centre projects are further north in the Edmonton and Grande Prairie areas.

- **Fiber Connectivity and Latency:** High-speed, low-latency network connections are vital. Proximity to fiber-optic cables and internet exchange points is necessary for data transfer. This is not available at or near the site. This is why a site like Olds, Alberta is being looked at because of the super high-speed fiber optics at that location and it being midway between Edmonton and Calgary.

- **Proximity to Talent and Customers:** While not as critical as power, being near tech hubs allows for access to specialized labor and reduced latency for end-users. Being closer to main urban centres is preferable. The specialized labour will prefer an urban setting in many cases. The talent pool in cities is much larger and by also having employment opportunities for spouses or partners is very important. In

addition, housing would be an issue too. We are probably talking about 120-150 families to get the skilled people required. This proposal said roughly 100 long term jobs, but with a power plant and waste treatment site there will be a requirement for additional highly skilled trades people to run and maintain the supporting equipment. This location will mean pretty much everyone would have to commute to site from other locations.

- Is there sufficient natural gas and a large enough pipeline for natural gas in the area or will a new pipeline have to be run?
- **Waste Water Recycling.** This is another reason why some of the proposed sites are closer to Urban Centres. Again, the Grande Prairie proposal is in an existing planned Industrial Park with water and waste management facilities.
 - It is not just water that goes into cooling the IT equipment. Additives to the “clean” water can include **corrosion inhibitors**, **biocides** to kill bacteria/algae, **dispersants**, and **pH adjusters** to maintain water balance and **glycol** (ethylene or propylene).
 - Waste removal has become a significant issue with some data centre sites in the USA, mainly because of the toxic nature of the waste from the water treatment plant. Waste water will probably have to be trucked to a disposal well further increasing highway traffic.

More In Depth Discussion of Some of the Issues:

Electrical Power:

It appears that Palliser will not be able to get the power from the grid as originally proposed and will have to build some sort of power generation plant. The only feasible choice would probably be a plant similar to the Enmax Shepard Energy Centre east of Calgary. The Enmax Shepard plant is considered the most efficient Natural Gas plant in Canada, so it is a good benchmark. It also uses steam generation from the water used to cool the natural gas turbines. Thus 1/3 of the power comes from steam. It still emits CO₂ but roughly half of a coal fired plant of the same size. There are a lot of water vapours (steam) coming out of the cooling vents which may not be visually appealing.

The Shepard Energy Centre produce 830MW of power. That is enough for half of Calgary's needs.

Emissions from this power plant are about 1.5 million metric tonnes per year. Significantly less than a coal fired plant but still the equivalent of about what 318,000 cars produce in a year. They are exploring carbon capture.

This facility also uses about 6 million cubic litres of reclaimed water annually. They have a 14 Km long pipeline coming from Calgary's Bonnybrook Water Treatment Plant to the Shepard power plant. That is over 4,800 acre-feet of water annually

Shepard Energy Centre during the day. (60 acres of land)



Shepard Energy Centre during the evening. Note the Lights and the Cooling Towers are 22 stories high. Buildings look to be about half that height or more. A significant landscape change if a similar project went forth on the proposed site.



Potential Power Plant based on the Shapard example:

Since we have no information on a Power Plant design for Palliser, I am assuming the most efficient plant in Canada would be a good comparable.

- **Palliser is proposing up to 2000MW of power required over 4 phases**
- Palliser indicated that their PUE (Power Utilization Efficiency) goal is 1.05 to 1.10. The PUE is calculated as the ratio of total facility energy to IT equipment energy. A very efficient facility would have a PUE of 1.2...so this facility is projected to be super-efficient. That might be difficult if they are also running a full water waste treatment facility.
- I am assuming getting natural gas to the plant will not be an issue other than a larger pipeline may be required. However here are some additional concerns:
- **Increased construction time.** The Shepard Energy Centre took over 3.5 years to build from first shovel in the ground to full power. This will increase construction and construction traffic in the area considerably.

- **Larger footprint.** Note that the Shepard Energy Centre produces 860-880 MW of power which is enough to power about half of Calgary needs and is on a 60.-acre site. The proposed AI Data Centre, if fully completed, will require up to 2000 MW of power. It's highly unlikely that that facility would hit peak usage. I have read most data centres use about 65%-70% of their design limits. A 2000 MW Data Centre facility maybe requires 1400 MW of energy and if it is very efficient, they would need another 20% for their non-IT requirements, therefore a 1680 MW energy facility if the project had all 4 phases. The size of this plant will be at least double that of Shepard.
- **Water Usage.** Shepard uses only reclaimed water from Calgary Waste Management services. If it didn't it would need to draw about six million cubic meters of water annually. That is over 4,800 acre-feet of water. If the AI Data Centre is only twice as large then they are looking in the range of 10,000 acre-feet of water. That is well above the 5,400 acre-feet of water that Palliser has permits for. And that does not include the water required for cooling the AI Data Centre.
- **Sightlines.** The cooling towers for a Natural Gas power plant are very large and can be up to 200 meters high. Shepard's are 22 stories (60+ metres) high.
- **Pollution.** As indicted earlier, Shepard still emits significant CO2 but roughly half of a coal fired plant of the same size. There are a lot of water vapours (steam) coming out of the cooling vents which may not be visually appealing. Some of the larger data centres are proposing carbon capture for their power generation plants and I can see this as probably a government requirement. This very expensive and requires a lot of preliminary work to define the substrata in the earth to see if it is even possible. Ie; lots of seismic and testing would be required. They will have to be water storage onsite so additional ponds will be required to hold the water and recycled water.

Cooling System:

Palliser is also proposing a water-cooled system for the IT equipment. Not knowing the details of the proposed system, it is very hard to determine the water usage...but based on the potential power usage it appears there may be no water available from the Travers Reservoir. Palliser claims that their WUE (Water Utilization Efficiency) of 0.1 to 0.5 litres per kWh. It is hard to determine if the WUE number is after the waste recycling or not. If there was no recycling the water then for a 500MW Phase I they would need between 438 million litres and 2.2 million litres of water per day based on using the above WUE rates (which appear not to be based on any detailed designs yet). This seems like a lot of water but is within the 5,400 acre-feet of water Palliser has a permit for. Therefore, without knowing any of the design or system they are proposing we have to leave it there.

The design of the Power Plant and the Cooling system will determine if there is enough water for both. Right now it does not appear that way based on the information we have.

Conclusion

I do not believe this site is ideal for a data centre and I would be a bit surprised if a potential client was identified. Its main advantage is that it is close to a clean water source. The disadvantages are many. It may be considered too remote especially when competitive sites are proposing locations near major centres and using water and waste management facilities in those centres. For instance, Grande Prairie has an industrial park fully serviced that one site is being proposed for. Olds also has a proposed site. Both of those are also getting some pushback from certain sectors of their citizens.

From a Little Bow Resort perspective, I believe this industrial facility is way too large and not suitable for the area and ruins the Vulcan County prized recreational area.

Do you recall what Wabamun Lake west of Edmonton looked like a few years ago? I could never figure out why that county let TransAlta build there but it was probably for the water. The facility is now decommissioned, and I think it is completely demolished now.



I know I would prefer not to look across a lake and see a power plant. The noise pollution will be there and light pollution too. I am sure it will affect animals in the area.

Sincerely,

Morley Myden
[REDACTED] Lakeside Drive

From: [Samantha Taylor](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Proposed By-Law 2026-007
Date: June 2, 2026 9:41:25 PM

[REDACTED]

In regard to the Application for proposed By-Law 2026-007, an Application made by Mr. Steeves to have his land redesignated “Industrial” instead of “Rural”, I believe the Application should be denied by the County of Vulcan councillors.

The lands which he has asked the County to redesignate are inappropriate for the designation he seeks. Those lands are adjacent to the Little Bow Reservoir and its surrounds. There are wetlands upon which many waterfowl have nested. In addition, the lands surrounding the reservoir provide a home to many species of prairie animals. There are provincial park lands upon which County of Vulcan residents and Albertans from over camp and fish. A nearby housing development has nearly 250 houses where many County of Vulcan farmers have moved in their retirement years. There are a variety of land uses in the area. Non of which are compatible with the facility which Mr. Steeves proposes.

Mr. Steeves has failed in his duty to provide tangible evidence that the facility he wishes to be developed on the land is appropriately sited. His only evidence that his land is sited properly for a data centre is that he owns the land and wants it to become the home of the largest data centre in Alberta.

This county should not be swayed by Mr. Steeves’ arguments without evidence. He should need to prove that if he finds someone who wishes to construct a data centre on that land, the data centre will not negatively impact nearby residents: fish and fowl, flora and fauna and, of course, human, prior to any redesignation being considered.

It is not enough for him to say that his development will have no effect upon those nearby residents, he has an obligation to provide evidence of his assertions. It is your duty to force him to do so. We, and all other county residents, require you to fulfill your obligation to do due diligence in regard to this Application because it is such a controversial, environmentally hot topic; one that is clearly new and upcoming and has not been researched as to its long term harmful impacts.

Thank you,

Samantha Taylor

From: [Shania Howe](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Proposed Bylaw No 2026-007- Industrial Zoning for AI Plant
Date: June 2, 2026 8:28:45 PM

Dear Alena,

I am writing to formally oppose and request the denial of the proposed AI data centre development in our community.

While technological innovation is important, this project presents significant risks and costs that outweigh its potential benefits to local residents, farmers, and the environment.

One of the most concerning issues is the enormous demand for water required to operate AI data centres. At a time when local farmers face ongoing challenges obtaining irrigation rights and securing sufficient water for agricultural production, it is difficult to justify allocating large volumes of water to support artificial intelligence computing.

Agriculture provides essential food production, supports local livelihoods, and contributes directly to the regional economy. Prioritizing an industrial data centre over the needs of farmers sends the wrong message about our community's values and long-term priorities.

The project would also place substantial demands on the electrical grid. AI data centres are among the most energy-intensive industrial facilities being developed today. Their operation requires vast amounts of power, potentially increasing pressure on existing infrastructure and creating additional environmental impacts. Residents should not bear the burden of higher infrastructure costs or reduced system reliability to support a facility that provides limited direct benefits to the community.

Furthermore, the economic benefits of this proposal appear overstated. While construction may create temporary jobs, AI data centres typically employ relatively few permanent workers once operational. In contrast, the long-term environmental and resource costs remain with the community for decades.

The proposal also raises concerns regarding land use, traffic, noise, environmental sustainability, and the precedent it sets for future industrial development. Before approving such a project, decision-makers must ask whether dedicating valuable land, water, and energy resources to AI computing serves the broader public interest. Given the significant concerns surrounding water allocation, energy consumption, environmental impacts, and limited long-term economic benefits, I respectfully urge the approving authority to reject this application.

Our community's resources should be directed toward projects that provide clear and

lasting benefits to residents, support local agriculture, protect the environment, and promote sustainable economic growth.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Shania & Brett Howe

Get [Outlook for iOS](#)

From: [Jack Redekop](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026-007, Proposed redesignation of agricultural land to light industrial by Pioneer Grid
Date: June 3, 2026 8:37:18 AM
Attachments: [Tannis Redekop June 10 AI Data Centre Presentation.docx](#)

Please find below and attached presentation for the hearing scheduled for June 10 in Champion.

Sincerely, Tannis Redekop, [REDACTED] Lakeside Drive, Little Bow Resort

Dear Councillors,

Re: Bylaw 2026-007, in reference to Pioneer Grid proposal to redesignate land to industrial

I respectfully urge you to examine the harmful effects of allowing an industrial designation in place of our current rural landscape.

In our natural pursuit of progress, we must remain cautious in stewarding our resources, while protecting and guarding the vulnerable.

It's important to stop and examine our motives before making changes.

I believe that the importance of healthy living & guarding our natural habitat...FAR outweigh the importance of economic benefit and monetary gain for one local family and a company headquartered thousands of miles away, probably in another country.

I have included the sources of numerous scientific studies, showing the dangerous effects for those living close to AI Data centres, resulting in degenerative health conditions which are accumulative and long-term.

Some of the issues causing these health concerns stem from...

-24/7 light & 24/7 noise/sound pollution; causing sleep disorders & psychological distress.

-Toxic air emissions of forever chemicals (PFAS);

-Eco-system disruptor airborne particles;

-Loud Diesel generator toxic emissions (DEP,s) linked to endocrine disruptors and to cancer;

-Extreme water consumption from the failure of closed loop systems, potentially in times of drought, when farmers need it the most for irrigation of their crops;

-Water contamination affecting farmers cattle & land- irrigation, fish and wildlife, our drinking water and our recreational swimming areas.

The Increased risk of psychological and neurological disorders, shortened lifespans, asthma, stroke, cancer & heart conditions etc.will drastically reduce the quality of life of people living and visiting within this area.

There is deep concern for the health & wellbeing of those working at and attending the bible camp located within a mile and a half of the proposed location. (1731 children as of this past year with (298) yearly staff & volunteers, ranging in ages from 14-78 years old. 1700, and 298 full and part time staff), the 270 families (50+ permanent residents) directly adjacent to the Bible Camp at Little Bow Resort, and the Lomond & Champion residents.

As well as concern for the neighbouring farmers, who have dedicated their lifetime supplying healthy & nourishing food supplies, for most of us sitting here today. Based on observations from the previous hearing, it appears none of the surrounding farmers support this redesignation.

Their enjoyment of this area would be completely compromised with the sound of the humming generators in the background and enough light that makes midnight seem like noon-day. (please refer to actual light and sounds of AI centres in the YouTube links provided in the other presentations).

The people mentioned above are the vulnerable souls who stand to loose the most, whom God expects leaders to protect. We are also liable for the protection of future generations whom I believe we will be held accountable for, by the decisions we make in the here and now!

Mr. Steeves, if you care about the people in your community, as you say you do, you would have Pioneer Grid withdraw your proposal for bringing industrial pollution & havoc to your neighbours.

Thank you for listening & for your time & consideration in regard to these deeply agonizing concerns!

Bibliography Resources:

- ECRI Environmental HEALTH Sciences 2025/2026
- NIH National Library of Medicine
- Science Direct.com
- Association of Health Care Journalists
- University of Alabama at Birmingham.study
- Stax Engineering.com
- healthjournals.org
- Net Zero Insights
- Air Power Weekly.com

From: [Tom Taylor](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Proposed Bylaw 2026-007
Date: June 3, 2026 8:38:44 AM

[s/LearnAboutSenderIdentification \]](#)

I urge the County of Vulcan councillors to refuse the application being made by Palliser Grid in the proposed Bylaw 2026- 007. That application is not well founded in its present form. It lacks substance by way of evidence that subject lands:

- a. Are appropriately sited for an intense, large scale industrial use, and
- b. Are not too close to environmentally sensitive areas.

Additionally, the application fails to consider the negative effect of the proposed development, the potential for a nuisance being caused to passersby, nearby residents, campers, fishermen, recreational users of the adjacent lake and others.

Palliser Grid has a duty to this Council to provide a fulsome application, not one which merely promises increased tax revenues to the County. Even though costs of operating this County continue to rise faster than tax revenues, this Council must ensure that any proposed development is properly situated, not within one mile of a provincial recreation area nor within the same distance from an environmentally sensitive area and a number of residences, including a community with more than 200 homes. Surely Palliser Grid can find land which is not so close to protected areas for the purpose for their development.

I attended the County offices for the April 1, 2026 public hearing and heard Mr. Steeves, on behalf of Palliser Grid, the Applicant, disparage nearby residents, suggesting that they were “well off” city residents who had no connection with the area. Rather than disparaging his neighbours, he should have spent the time available to him to explain how the proposed development would not be “unsightly and offensive”. He ought to have provided evidence that a redesignation of this land and development of a data centre of the size and scale suggested in his proposal, would not affect the adjacent “environmentally significant area” nor the adjacent provincial recreation area in a negative manner (noise, light, environment waste and/or contamination).

This Council has a duty to consider facts rather than promises and suppositions. Please take your duty to heart and force the Applicant to provide the evidence which the proper consideration of this Application deserves. Due diligence must be done prior to approving.

Thank you.

Tom Taylor

Sent from my iPhone

From: [Joanna Parker](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: June 10th meeting
Date: May 25, 2026 2:35:43 PM

Good Day:

My name is Joanna Parker and I live at [REDACTED] Cottonwood Dr. in Vulcan.

The reason for my email today is in regards to the land change application as listed below:

" 15-21 W4 containing approximately 350± ha (865± acres) as shown on Schedule 'A', from "Rural General - RG" to "Rural Industrial - RI". The purpose of the proposed amendment is to develop the property in accordance with the provisions of the Rural Industrial Land Use District".

I strongly request that this motion not to pass. This land should be left in the condition currently stated and not become rural industrial Property.

I see no benefit to things like a AI data centre being brought into our community and we as the residents will not gain anything from this being in our backyard.

I am sorry I am not able to attend this meeting due to the time of day in which it is being held, I would be open to a conversation if you choose to reach out to me. 519-495-3875.
Please consider this a vote of NO to the request to change this property.

Thank you

Joanna Parker

From: [Jackie Maltais](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Re: Notice of Public Hearing Bylaw 2026-007
Date: May 23, 2026 4:36:56 PM

Thank you for this information. We have no objections. Good luck to Eric and investors!

Have a wonderful day.
Alan and Jackie Maltais

On May 22, 2026, at 2:05 PM, Alena Matlock <devassist@vulcancounty.ab.ca> wrote:

Good afternoon,

Please see attached Notice regarding a Public Hearing for Bylaw 2026-007.

Thank you,

Alena Matlock

Development Officer

Vulcan County

102 Centre Street | Box 180 | Vulcan | T0L 2B0

Office: (403) 485-2241

Fax: (403) 485-2920

devassist@vulcancounty.ab.ca

<PH Notice - BLLP Review - 1414-1423-7216;3.pdf>

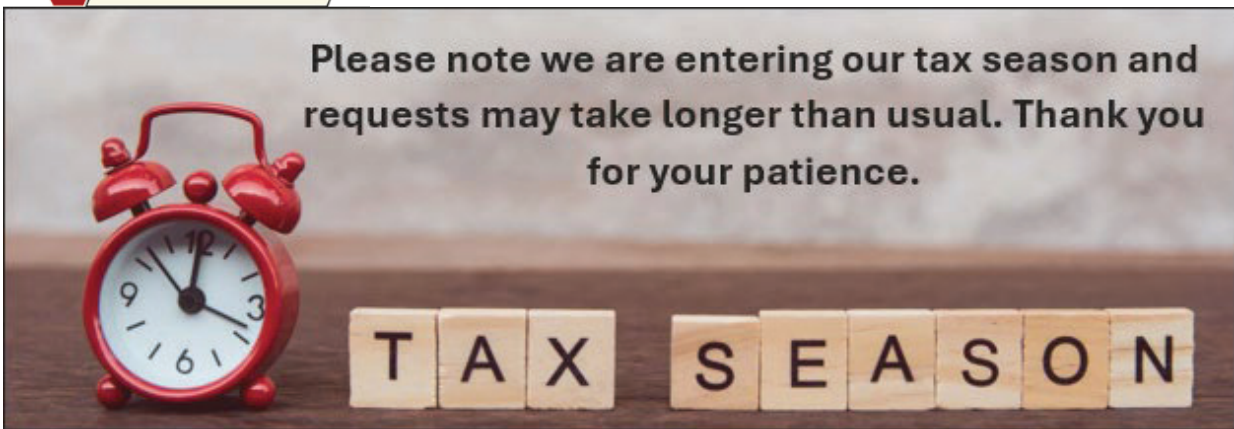
From: [Samanthia Haines](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Fw: Vulcan County "Rezoning"
Date: May 25, 2026 8:13:12 AM
Attachments: [Outlook-pexbckm1.png](#)
[Outlook-xdomsztm.png](#)

Samanthia Haines

Customer Service & Accounts Receivable Representative

Ph: 403-485-2241

Fax: 403-485-2920



Please note, requests for tax certificates are processed in 1-5 business days after payment is received.

From: Vulcan County <vcwebmail@vulcancounty.ab.ca>
Sent: Saturday, May 23, 2026 11:50 AM
To: Samanthia Haines <reception@vulcancounty.ab.ca>
Subject: Vulcan County "Rezoning"

From: Jacqueline J Meeks [REDACTED]
Subject: Rezoning

Message Body:

I would love if someone could provide the email addresses of the Reeve and councillors directly, but barring that please see my email below. I also have a follow-up with research I would like to provide to be appended to my message.

Dear Reeve Schneider and Members of Council,

I regret that I will be unable to attend the June 10, 2026 hearing due to work commitments. I respectfully request that this letter be entered into the public record and considered as correspondence regarding the proposed rezoning of the Steeves/Palliser Grid property.

I am not opposed to economic development, technological investment, or responsible industrial growth within Vulcan County. However, I am opposed to proceeding with this rezoning at this time because I do not believe sufficient independent research and public analysis have yet been completed

regarding the long-term impacts of a project of this scale.

My position is not “never.” It is “not yet.”

1. Agricultural Land Should Not Be Converted Without Demonstrating Clear Public Benefit

The proposed rezoning would permanently convert a significant area of agricultural land to industrial use.

Agricultural land is a finite resource. Once converted, it is rarely restored to productive agricultural capacity. As a municipality whose identity, economy, and tax base have long been rooted in agriculture, Vulcan County should require compelling evidence that the long-term public benefits outweigh the permanent loss of farmland.

Before approving rezoning, Council should clearly demonstrate:

- * Why agricultural land is the preferred location;
- * Whether alternative industrial sites were evaluated;
- * The long-term opportunity cost of removing this land from agricultural production;
- * How the proposal aligns with Vulcan County’s long-term municipal development objectives.

Land-use decisions of this magnitude should be evaluated on a generational timeline rather than a short-term economic timeline.

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This e-mail was sent from a contact form on Vulcan County (<https://www.vulcancounty.ab.ca>)

From: [Jacqueline Meeks](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Proposed Rezoning of the Steeves/Palliser Grid Property
Date: May 25, 2026 11:45:29 AM

Dear Reeve and Members of Council,

I am writing regarding the proposed rezoning of the Steeves/Palliser Grid property.

Unfortunately, due to work commitments, I will be unable to attend the June 10 hearing. However, I wish to have my concerns entered into the public record.

I am not opposed to economic development, technological innovation, or responsible investment in Vulcan County. However, I believe Council should proceed with caution and ensure that all long-term impacts are fully understood before approving the rezoning of approximately 850 acres of productive agricultural land for industrial use.

My primary concern is that important questions remain unanswered.

1. Agricultural Land is a Finite Resource

Once productive farmland is converted to industrial use, it is rarely returned to agriculture. While data centres may offer economic benefits, Council should carefully consider whether this project represents the highest and best use of agricultural land in the long term.

Many municipalities across Alberta are currently wrestling with balancing industrial development against the preservation of productive farmland. In 2025, Rocky View County rejected a major data-centre proposal in part because council felt the proposed location was incompatible with surrounding agricultural uses.

The question before Council should not simply be whether a data centre can be built here, but whether this is the right place to build it.

2. Water Use Requires Greater Scrutiny

Southern Alberta is one of the most water-constrained regions in Canada. Water security is already a major issue for agriculture, municipalities, and industry.

The proponent's own materials indicate that a full build-out could involve significant annual water consumption and that an amendment for 5,500 acre-feet of water has reportedly been secured through the Bow River Irrigation District.

Before rezoning proceeds, I believe residents deserve clear answers to questions such as:

- What is the projected annual water consumption during each phase of development?
- How will drought years affect water availability?
- What impacts could this have on future agricultural water security?
- Has an independent hydrological assessment been completed and made publicly available?
- What contingency plans exist if water demand exceeds projections?

Across North America, concerns regarding data-centre water use are becoming increasingly common as AI infrastructure expands. Municipalities are being forced to balance industrial water demands with agricultural and residential needs.

3. Power Infrastructure and Community Impacts

Data centres require enormous amounts of electricity.

The proposed Palliser Grid project is being promoted as a large-scale AI and data-processing corridor that could eventually reach gigawatt-scale energy consumption.

Recent controversies in the United States have demonstrated the importance of understanding who ultimately bears the cost of power-system upgrades. Communities have raised concerns about utilities prioritizing infrastructure investments for large data-centre projects while ratepayers shoulder increasing costs.

Council should ensure that independent studies clearly identify:

- Who pays for transmission upgrades?
- Whether local residents or agricultural producers could experience indirect impacts.
- How future expansion phases may affect regional infrastructure requirements.
- The long-term implications of introducing industrial-scale power demand into a predominantly agricultural area.

4. Taxation and Net Economic Benefit

Supporters frequently cite tax revenue and economic development benefits.

However, before rezoning occurs, I believe Council should provide residents with a clear and transparent analysis of:

- Expected municipal tax revenue.
- Additional infrastructure costs.
- Road maintenance requirements.
- Emergency service impacts.
- Long-term servicing obligations.
- Net municipal benefit after expenses.

While it has been noted that non-residential assessment would generate substantially more tax revenue than agricultural land, residents should understand both the revenues and the costs before a decision is made.

5. Lessons From Other Alberta Projects

The recent rejection of the proposed Synapse Data Centre project in Olds provides an important lesson.

The Alberta Utilities Commission cited insufficient information, deficiencies in environmental assessments, and shortcomings in public engagement when denying the application.

I am not suggesting the Palliser Grid proposal suffers from the same issues. However, the Olds decision demonstrates the importance of ensuring that all environmental, infrastructure, and community concerns are thoroughly examined before approvals advance.

Request to Council

My request is simple:

Pump the brakes.

I respectfully ask Council to delay any final rezoning decision until residents have access to comprehensive independent information regarding:

- Water consumption and drought resilience.
- Agricultural land impacts.
- Long-term power infrastructure requirements.
- Municipal taxation and cost-benefit analysis.
- Environmental assessments.
- Noise, heat, lighting, and cumulative industrial impacts.

Rezoning agricultural land is a permanent decision. Once that land is industrialized, there is no practical way to reverse course.

Vulcan County has a proud agricultural history. Economic development is important, but so is ensuring that decisions made today remain beneficial fifty years from now.

I encourage Council to proceed carefully, gather additional independent evidence, and ensure that all questions are fully answered before considering a rezoning of this scale.

Thank you for your consideration and for your service to the residents of Vulcan County.

Respectfully submitted,

Jacqueline Meeks

Resident and Ratepayer
Vulcan County, Alberta

From: [Patrick Jeanson](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Cc: [Jason Schneider](#); [Doug Logan](#); [Jodie Gateman](#); [Alex Horkoff](#); [Laurie Lyckman](#); [Kelly Nelson](#); [Christopher Northcott](#); [Nels Petersen](#); [Lansey Middleton](#)
Subject: Vulcan County Objection - Bylaw 2026-007 - Patrick Jeanson
Date: May 25, 2026 1:28:48 PM
Attachments: [Vulcan County Objection - Bylaw 2026-007 25May2026- Patrick Jeanson.pdf](#)

[REDACTED]

Hi Alena,

Ahead of the Bylaw 2026-007 Public Hearing scheduled for June 10th, 2026, find attached my objection letter regarding the proposed rezoning proposal. I request that this correspondence be included in the official record for Bylaw 2026-007.

Looking forward to attending the Public Hearing.

Sincerely,

Patrick Jeanson, P. Eng
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]



Precise. Practical. Passionate.

This email, sent from [REDACTED] to devassist@vulcancounty.ab.ca on Mon May 25 13:28:36 MDT 2026, is confidential and may contain privileged or copyright information. If you are not devassist@vulcancounty.ab.ca please notify [REDACTED] and delete this email and you are notified that disclosing, copying, distributing or taking any action in reliance on the contents of this information is strictly prohibited. Any views or opinions presented in this email are solely those of the author and do not necessarily represent those of the company.

To: County of Vulcan Council

May 25th, 2026

RE: “Bylaw 2026-007 Public Hearing”

Dear Members of Council,

Ahead of the Bylaw 2026-007 Public Hearing scheduled for June 10th, 2026, I am writing as a property owner at the Little Bow resort to formally express my opposition to the proposed rezoning of agricultural land (Rural General) for industrial use (Rural Industrial), specifically for the future development of a large-scale data centre (AI facility).

While I recognize the importance of economic development and technological investment, I have serious concerns about the suitability of this location for such a high-intensity industrial use, particularly given its proximity to a valued recreational and environmentally sensitive water system.

As a professional engineer in the province of Alberta with over 30 years experience in manufacturing, I am very familiar with cooling systems and a primary concern is the significant water demand associated with large-scale data centre operations. AI-driven computing facilities require continuous cooling, and many rely on substantial water consumption for evaporative or hybrid cooling systems. The proximity of this proposed development to Travers Reservoir raises questions about long-term water sustainability, especially during periods of drought or peak recreational use in the summer months. Any increased draw on local water resources or potential thermal or chemical discharge risk could have direct consequences for water quality, aquatic ecosystems, and recreational usability of the reservoir.

In addition, industrial-scale data centres introduce continuous power demand, heat output, noise from cooling infrastructure, and increased truck traffic during construction and maintenance phases. These impacts are not consistent with the current agricultural and recreational character of the area, and they risk diminishing the natural experience that residents, visitors, and tourism operators rely upon.

The Travers Reservoir and Little Bow Resort represent an important regional asset for recreation, tourism, and environmental value. Once industrial zoning is approved in proximity to such a resource, the changes are effectively permanent and may set a precedent for further industrial encroachment.

For these reasons, I respectfully request that Council reject the proposed rezoning application and consider alternative sites better suited for heavy industrial development, ideally located away from sensitive water bodies and recreational zones.

Thank you for your consideration. I trust Council will carefully weigh the long-term environmental, recreational, and community impacts of this proposal in its decision-making.

I also request that this correspondence be included in the official record for Bylaw 2026-007.

Thank you for your attention to this matter. I look forward to your response.

Sincerely,



Patrick Jeanson, P.Eng.

Little Bow Resort

CC:

Jason Schneider, Reeve, Division 3

Doug Logan, Division 7

Jodie Gateman, Division 1

Alex Horkoff, Division 2

Laurie Lyckman, Division 4

Kelly Nelson, Division 5

Christopher Northcott, Division 6

Nels Petersen, Chief Administrative Officer

Lansey Middleton, Manager of Legislative Services

Alena Matlock, Development Officer

jason.schneider@vulcan.ca

doug.logan@vulcan.ca

jodie.gateman@vulcan.ca

alex.horkoff@vulcan.ca

laurie.lyckman@vulcan.ca

kelly.nelson@vulcan.ca

christopher.northcott@vulcan.ca

cao@vulcancounty.ab.ca

ea@vulcancounty.ab.ca

devassist@vulcancounty.ab.ca

From: [Corinne Cook](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Fwd: Little Bow Resort Bylaw 2026-007
Date: May 25, 2026 6:48:16 PM

Please receive my voice on the matter of the AI Data Centre proposal in our beloved Little Bow Resort despite not being able to be at the meetings as I'll be at work. Many thanks for reading and considering my below letter.

Sent from my iPhone

Begin forwarded message:

From: Corinne Cook [REDACTED]
Date: April 3, 2026 at 2:07:08 PM MDT
To: ea@vulcancounty.ab.ca
Subject: Little Bow Resort Bylaw 2026-007

Apologies for my late email as I am only hearing about the issue regarding the Little Bow Resort and the plant that is proposed to be built nearby that would decimate what is a currently a beautiful quiet paradise and has been for our family for 30 years. My mother loved the cabin with all her heart but is now unable to enjoy it as she has Alzheimer's and lives in a home but we love it for her and enjoy very very peaceful days there paddle boarding and swimming in the clear water and fishing on the ice and walking the sandy edges of the beach in fall and winter.

We had always planned on handing down the cabin from generation to generation as my dad built 80% of it himself!!! It is a cherished family heirloom full of love and a place for us to escape the realities and stress of current times in the world and reconnect with nature.

I beg of you to please decline this building near our beloved resort that we pay SO much for to maintain and have for decades. It would absolutely ruin the peace we have there and will hurt the environment that we've all loved and enjoyed for so long.

Please consider that this is a cherished area by anyone who lives there or enjoys their property during the summer with their family and friends as there are so few places like this especially in Alberta for us to enjoy.

I am super grateful that you are hearing our pleas and will know the right thing to do is to not allow this in our area and so near the wonderful Provincial Little Bow Park which I know many also enjoy.

Thank you so much for helping us keep this area as pristine as possible going forward for our families to continue with real life celebrations and not polluting it

with modern companies and ideas.

Corinne Cook
Sent from my iPhone

From: [Greg James](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026-007
Date: May 26, 2026 5:26:41 PM

I would like to register my concerns with this bylaw change. At the first meeting, the person running it wanted to down play this and say it was just a land change bylaw, but you wouldn't be doing this without the AI development being considered. You must look at both matters. I am against the change and development for the following reasons and have concerns how it's being handled.

- 1) the councillor for our area at little bow resort never reached out asking for our thoughts towards it,
- 2) I think it's horrible that areas are being offered bribes to get behind it,,,,,free money, free upgrades...what they are doing is the definition of bribery,
- 3) Taking prime farm land for something few want in the county is horrible, this land can't be replaced,
- 4) The excess water use is horrible, we in Alberta are running out of water. This godly site in recreational land is in poor taste,
- 5) The health concerns raised in numerous studies needs to be considered, your opening up people to health problems we don't need,
- 6) Noise pollution, toxic waste, light pollution, storing of large amounts of flammable liquids put people in danger. We don't have the fire departments to protect the people and their homes when something happens,
- 7) Little Bow resort has one way in, when the fire comes, no escape route,,,,,
- 8) electrical rates have been shown to increase drastically,
- 9) Water rates have shown to increase drastically,
- 10) insurance rates have been shown to increase,
- 11) the development is too close to waterway,
- 12) this development is only in place to make a few people wealthy.
- 13) house values have show. To decrease.

I ask that the councillors listen to the people who voted them in, don't be bribed, fooled, vote how ur constituents want you to vote.

This is poorly located, the land owner has tried to sneak this thru without consulting any of the people affected. He should be ashamed what he wants to do to this area.

I have lived down here for 20 years, it sickens me what they are trying to do

Greg and Gale James
[REDACTED] Littlebow Resort.

From: [Jay Jay](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Little Bow Resort Bylaw #2026-007
Date: May 26, 2026 5:44:02 PM

[REDACTED]

To whom it may concern, I would like to have my voice heard that I am against this AI data centre and any other technology building to be built in this proposed area. We are property owners in the Little Bow Resort and building this AI project would have tragic consequences to our environment, community, and existing farm land nearby.

We are already hearing the tragic consequences happening in other locations in North America when these Environmental killing sites are built. I ask please to deny any further processing of this project.

There are way more negatives to our environment that will affect so many areas, people, farms, water supply, noise pollution, light pollution, increases in power bills, much more stress on our already tight provincial power grid if this project goes through. Please do not let this project happen!

Thank you,
Jason Cook

[REDACTED]

From: [Roger Snider](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Bylaw 2026-007
Date: May 26, 2026 9:15:19 AM

[REDACTED]

I am opposed to Bylaw 2026-077 redesignation of Section 14 and portions of the E1/2 of 15-15-21-W4 from Rural General to Rural Industrial.

I would think before any land use change is granted the soil should be checked and evaluated for agricultural use before it ever got changed to industrial. It would be a waste of good farmland.

An industrial development of approximately 865 acres would be completely incompatible with the surrounding recreational, residential, lake, and provincial park environment. This proposal would permanently alter the character of the area and negatively affect nearby landowners, visitors, wildlife, and the natural environment.

The nuisance of increased heavy truck traffic, industrial noise, light pollution, and industrial activity from a facility of this size would have a serious and negative impact on neighbouring properties, lake users, campers, boaters, anglers, and visitors to the provincial park. This area was established and valued for irrigation, recreation, natural beauty, and quiet enjoyment, not heavy industrial development.

The proposed redesignation also raises serious environmental concerns. This area is part of a bird migration path and wildlife habitat. Industrial activity on this scale creates the potential for spills, runoff, air pollution, groundwater contamination, and other environmental damage that could directly impact the lake, fishing, water quality, and surrounding ecosystems. Once contamination occurs, the damage may be irreversible.

Approval of a Rural Industrial designation on such a large area could set a precedent for additional industrial expansion in the future, further changing the character of the region and increasing long-term impacts on the lake and recreational area.

The area is not prepared for the level of emergency response that would be required for a major industrial incident, hazardous materials spill, fire, or other accidents associated with a development of this size. Increased traffic would create additional safety concerns for residents and recreational users.

There are also concerns regarding strain on water resources, increased wildfire risk, noise and lighting extending into nighttime hours, and declining property values for nearby landowners. The introduction of a large industrial development beside a recreational lake and provincial park conflicts with the existing character and intended use of the area.

I believe this proposal is incompatible with the surrounding environment and does not provide sufficient benefit to outweigh the long-term risks and negative impacts to residents, recreation, wildlife, and the lake itself.

For these reasons, I respectfully request that Council reject Bylaw 2026-077 and preserve the existing Rural General designation in order to protect the lake area, provincial park, surrounding properties, wildlife habitat, recreation, and quality of life in the region.

Thank you

Roger Snider

[REDACTED] Lakeside Dr

Little bow resort

[REDACTED] Lomond Ab
[REDACTED]

From: [Susan Lucas](#)
To: [Jason Schneider](#); [Doug Logan](#); [Jodie Gateman](#); [Alex Horkoff](#); [Laurie Lyckman](#); [Kelly Nelson](#); [Christopher Northcott](#); [Nels Petersen](#); [Lansey Middleton](#); [Alena Matlock](#)
Cc: [Darrol](#)
Subject: Re: TO: County of Vulcan Council - Public Hearing for Bylaw 2026-007 Objection
Date: May 26, 2026 10:13:31 AM

[REDACTED]

As per the email I sent to you in April my concerns stand. Considering the knowledge my research has revealed, I am horrified that this is being considered. We are in a drought area where farmers need water to survive and support their livelihood. Water supply needed to run pivots has already been cut back over the past few years. Limited water supply is a problem in the province as evidenced by water restrictions imposed on southern Alberta cities. Windmills surround us, which speaks to the high winds in the area.

The area is a wildlife corridor for many species. I would like to see the research and due diligence you've done in this regard detailing the impact this development would have.

I am gravely concerned about the threat/safety issues with the huge volume of traffic this will generate on the surrounding roads.

Again, we are in a drought zone and fire is a potential disaster waiting to happen. Anyone who has fought a grass fire in the wind on the prairies knows this. THERE IS ONE ROAD INTO LITTLE BOW RESORT, WITH LIMITED EGRESS. ACCESS FOR EMERGENCY SERVICES IS A VERY REAL THREAT. THE THREAT TO HUMAN LIFE IS REAL!! Never mind the financial disaster to the 225 +/- homes. LBR is the only/primary residence of many residents.

I would appreciate confirmation that council has received my email detailing these very real threats.

Thank you,
Susan Lucas

Sent from my iPad

On Apr 8, 2026, at 1:57 PM, Susan Lucas [REDACTED]:

RE: Public Hearing for Bylaw 2026-007 Objection

I am writing to formally request that the public hearing for Bylaw 2026-007 be deemed invalid for the following reasons:

1. The hearing did not provide a fair or reasonable opportunity for meaningful public participation.
2. The County of Vulcan introduced in its online meeting agenda package a major scope change to the project that was not spoken to by the County nor the proponent. There was

new material information contained in this submission and no opportunity for participants to become aware of or comment upon these new items. The County did not provide the Applicant's submission in advance nor make the meeting attendees aware of its existence. The hearing did not have any meaningful discussion on this change which is directly related to the land use re-designation.

3. The County of Vulcan has erred in not including the land use associated with the project's associated pumping station and pipeline in this Bylaw. The sitting setbacks in the actual zoning designation were not met by the application and should be denied due to the proximity of the Travers Reservoir and recreational area.

Public Hearing Dated April 1st, 2026

I object to the manner in which the public hearing for Bylaw 2026-007 was conducted. The hearing did not provide a fair or reasonable opportunity for meaningful public participation. Due to insufficient venue capacity in the main Council Chamber, approximately forty plus attendees were directed to an overflow room where audio quality was extremely poor and no visual component of the presentations was provided until partway through the hearing. As a result, individuals in that room were unable to adequately hear or follow all of the discussion points.

This lack of access to the Council Chamber and poor audio/video in the overflow room caused frustration and led several attendees to leave the hearing prematurely. Importantly, some of those individuals intended to provide verbal submissions but were effectively prevented from doing so due to these conditions.

Public hearings are a critical component of the decision-making process and must be conducted in a manner that is transparent, accessible, and procedurally fair. In this case, the limitations in space and the failure to provide adequate audio-visual access meant that a portion of the public was effectively excluded from participating. This undermines the integrity of the hearing process and raises serious concerns regarding procedural fairness under the Municipal Government Act and the County's own Public Participation Policy. Given these circumstances, I respectfully request that:

- The public hearing for Bylaw 2026-007 be deemed invalid;
- A new public hearing be scheduled which would be additive to the April 1st participation with full opportunity for everyone to present old and new information;
- The County ensure that the venue can accommodate anticipated attendance;
- Adequate audio and visual access be provided in all areas, including any overflow spaces if required;
- Consideration be given for a portion of the hearing to be in the evening to accommodate those people whose jobs do not allow them access during the day or those that must travel from outside of Vulcan.

Major Change of Power Supply Scope Not Discussed

The project scope in first reading called for power sourced from the grid, with backup-diesel powered generation and battery energy storage intended for emergency use only.

In the Public Hearing Notification Package and in the April 1, 2025 Council Agenda Background & Proposal (pg. 2 of 96), the Vulcan County again stated the project as having "backup diesel power generators" only.

Pg. 20 of 96 the Palliser Grid Public Hearing Submission now states that "Palliser Grid plans to bring its own generation capacity". This is due to "facilities with their own generation pay as low as 1%" provincial levy. It is also most likely due to recent events whereas:

*The province's current **peak electricity demand** is about 12 gigawatts. In the last 18 months, the Alberta Utilities Commission (AUC) has fielded requests for large-load connection to the grid for more than 16 GW. In an attempt to manage the load on the grid, the Alberta Electric System Operator (AESO) has created a **temporary cap** of 1,200 megawatts for big projects. It has already allocated that entire amount to just two data centres near Edmonton.*

*With the cap reached, that leaves 37 proposed data-centre projects asking for a combined 19 GW of power, almost double the province's current generation. These projects will either have to build their own sources of power generation, or wait for new transmission lines — **a process that could take close to a decade**.* Source: <https://ucalgary.ca/sustainability/mobilizing-alberta/climate-action-blogs/will-ai-data-centres-raise-water-and-power-use-alberta>

Neither Vulcan County nor Palliser Grid made the hearing attendants aware of this major change of scope - **continuous power generation** on site. The County did not provide the Applicant's submission in advance or at the Public Hearing nor make the meeting attendees aware of its existence.

This represents a significant change to the scope and impacts of the project, including but not limited to air emissions, noise, and land use compatibility. This information was not disclosed during the public hearing, and therefore the public and decision-makers were not given a fair

As there was no public participation on this major change, a new public hearing should be conducted on this basis alone. Public hearings—especially for land use—are required to be transparent and allow for meaningful participation.

Land Use for the Associated Pump Station and Pipeline Not Contemplated

The pumping station is an essential component of the proposed development and was not disclosed, evaluated, or included in the land use decision. Its location near the reservoir, recreational areas, and environmentally-sensitive habitat introduces significant environmental and land use impacts that were not considered. This represents a fundamental flaw in both the application and the approval process.

I also request that this correspondence be included in the official record for Bylaw 2026-007

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Sent from my iPad

From: [Janine Jacobson](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Cc: [Janine Jacobson](#)
Subject: Proposed Bylaw 2026-007 Land Use Bylaw Amendment
Date: May 28, 2026 1:19:56 PM

Dear Sirs & Madams,

As a resident and taxpayer I am writing with great concern about this proposed Land Use Bylaw Amendment.

I strongly oppose this Amendment for the many reasons listed below, among others.

1. Any Rural Industrial designation would take away farm / grazing land and this is something that is much needed in our Province of Alberta.
2. What about the flora and fauna that would be destroyed with Industry building large sites? SE Alberta is home to many endangered plants (such as native prairie) and animals (burrowing owls to name one). Wildlife requires more farm/grazing land, not less. This would also include ungulates such as deer, antelope and moose as well as raptors such as bald eagles, golden eagles, hawks, etc.
3. Any Rural Industrial designation would also require additional water. The water reservoirs that we have are currently used by farmers for irrigation purposes. Any industry would require additional water, which would most likely increase the cost of water for Vulcan County residents and this valuable resource would be depleted quickly. Industrial activity could also release contaminated water.
4. This part of the province is prone to fires due to dry weather and high winds. Any industry would be an additional fire risk. If a fire were to start due to industrial activity, crops, livestock and homes would all be in danger.
5. My understanding is that utility rates would also increase due to industrial use of another of our valuable resources - electricity.
What would happen during a heatwave or grid emergency?
Would our current grid handle the additional load?
6. Any industries building where this proposal is would require additional infrastructure (roads, etc.). Who would be paying for this?
Besides new roads, there would also be a need to plow snow in the winter and grade the gravel and/or maintain pavement in the summer.
I can only assume that the taxpayers would be paying for this also?

In summary, I would like to see the Proposed Bylaw 2026-007 Land Use Bylaw Amendment **NOT** be approved.

Regards

Janine Jacobson

[REDACTED]

Vulcan, AB T0L 2B0

From: [Dwayne Dallmann](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Fwd: Bylaw 2026-007
Date: May 29, 2026 12:13:43 PM

----- Forwarded message -----

From: **Cathy Dallmann** [REDACTED] >
Date: Fri, May 29, 2026 at 12:06 PM
Subject: Re: Bylaw 2026-007
To: Dwayne Dallmann [REDACTED]

Looks great!

On May 29, 2026, at 11:58 AM, Dwayne Dallmann
[REDACTED] wrote:

Vulcan County Council Members,

Cathy and I would like to express to all of you that any industrial compound, complex or campus that could cover the area being considered for rezoning (850 acres) at the location requested by the applicant is strongly opposed by us in every way. We are not against economic development or improvement in Vulcan County at all, we just can't imagine that the council would consider a project of this size at the proposed location for the following reasons.

First and foremost would definitely be the safety of the two major communities (SABC & LBR) that only have one road in and out of the area. Industrial projects always have massive amounts of hazardous materials onsite, and if one thing goes wrong and the winds are east to west that day...it could be a catastrophic outcome. The construction of industrial projects have a massive amount of big trucks and heavy equipment all converging on the one intersection that our communities have to frequent on a daily basis year round.

We understand that at the zoning stage the applicant could go any number of directions with how they intend to utilize the area zoned as industrial. However, now for the second time the proposal reveals the nature of the project...AI Data Centre Campus. I have personally talked to Eric Steeves face to face several times, he has no intention of any other type of project for this property. So, for these reasons we believe we are entitled to express our specific opposition to any AI Data Centre projects. Cathy and I have done extensive research on these types of projects in Canada and the USA and have been shocked at some of the videos and news stories of these projects turning out nowhere near what was either proposed or promised to the local area. A quick Google of the project in Grand Prairie and Olds tells you that the environmental impact study for both of these

projects has been waived....Huh? There would only be one single reason for this to occur...they would never be able to pass the study in any way. To generate 2 GW of electricity continuously for one day, it takes roughly 147 million cubic feet to 184 million cubic feet of regasified natural gas. Can you imagine the emissions from that much natural gas per day! The Current AI Data Centres proposed in North America, if built WILL set back all of our climate change progress by more than 20 years. I noticed that the new proposal changed the amount of back up generation diesel fuel needed to be onsite for adequate runtime in case of a power outage...40 million liters up from 5 million. In May 2026, a massive Blackstone-backed AI data center in Fayetteville, Georgia, was discovered draining nearly 30 million gallons of unmetered water over a period of 9 to 15 months. The unauthorized usage was traced back to two industrial-scale hookups that bypassed official meters, causing local residents to suffer from low water pressure during a drought. These types of stories are getting more and more prevalent as even the "closed loop" cooling systems use evaporative towers on the exchange side as it is the cheapest way to cool the "closed loop" water running through the server buildings.

The noise and light pollution of these projects does seem to vary, and at 2km away we are not certain how this could affect us, but the inaudible low frequency of LNG power plants or Diesel generators is a major health risk for everyone in the area...including the wildlife.

The future certainly seems like AI is coming, so if we have to deal with it...shouldn't we all make sure that any one single or set of ratepayers are not bearing the majority of the detriment of these types of projects. How about the County of Vulcan becoming the developer of this project? Select an unusable section of County owned land that is 10km from any resident, and then spend a few million preparing the site to attract a lease agreement from a hyperscaler? The upside of this to the entire municipality is basically limitless!

Thank you for your time.

Dwayne & Cathy Dallmann

From: [Perry Wilford](#)
To: [Alena Matlock](#)
Subject: Written submission re: bylaw 2026-007.
Date: May 29, 2026 1:00:52 PM
Attachments: [image001.png](#)

[REDACTED]

Hello Vulcan County.

Please accept this as a submission for the upcoming land re-zoning meeting with reference to a proposal by Palliser Grid.

I am against the re-designation of the land in question to rural -industrial.

I am the owner of a recreation property located at Little Bow Resort. I have been an owner and tax payer there for 24 years. In my time there, we have seen the proliferation of windmills in the area and the exceptional amount of solar panels go up in our area. But they were nowhere near as obtrusive as what is being proposed by Palliser grid. To redesignate the land in question to Rural Industrial for the means of creating an AI centre with the power plants needed to run it, is by far an exceptional intrusion by industry into the recreational and agricultural area around Travers Dam.

This will severely damage our enjoyment of the area I bought into, and negatively affect the property value of my land and house. Vulcan county has a duty to all of it's tax payers and this is an issue that could potentially **severely damage the area forever**. Clearly the potential for damaging ecological effects from water, pollution and wildlife cannot be underestimated.

AI Centre aside, I am against the re-zoning of the land for any industrial usage. This could open up the door for any development that could be harmful to the area and its residents.

The recent meeting regarding this issue showed overwhelming opposition to this potential land use change. **I urge you to act on your constituent's behalf and deny this application.**

Perry Wilford
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Little Bow Resort.
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